



unrwa
الأونروا

*United Nations Relief and Works Agency for
Palestine Refugees in the near east*

Background Guide

SMUN, 2026

Table of contents

Table of contents	2
Letter from the Executive Board	5
Meet the Executive Board	6
Letter from the President of the UNRWA	17
About the committee	19
1 Statement of the Problem	20
1.1 What are Humanitarian Corridors?	20
1.2 How many active conflict zones and types of violence?	21
1.3 Humanitarian Laws-	23
1.4 Neutrality & Establishing Trust in Humanitarian Operations-	24
1.5 Palestinian Refugees in the Near East & the Israel-Palestine Conflict-	26
2. Timeline	28
3. Current Situation	34
3.1 Current status of refugees-	34
3.2 Current status of Humanitarian Corridors-	36
3.3 Data-	37
3.4 International Situation & UN Response (2025–2026)-	39
3.5 Israeli policies-	41
3.6 Case Studies-	42
4. Other countries around the world	44
(Opinions of other countries on Palestine)	44
United States of America (USA)-	44
France-	45
South Africa-	46
Israel-	46
Syria-	48
Yemen-	49
5. Other countries around the world	50
a) China-	50

b) Russia-	52
c) Iran-	53
d) United Kingdom-	54
e) Egypt-	55
f) India-	57
g) Pakistan-	58
h) Qatar-	59
i) Kuwait-	60
j) Oman-	62
k) Saudi Arabia-	63
l) UAE-	63
m) Jordan-	64
n) Lebanon-	65
6. Vulnerable Groups	65
a) Children-	66
b) People with disabilities-	67
c) Women-	70
d) Health-	71
7. Past UN Actions	72
8. Potential Reforms by Treaty Organisations	73
1. UNRWA urges the government of Israel, refugee asylum states and the rest of the warring parties to-	74
2. UNRWA urges all constituting parties to take prompt steps to ensure-	74
3. UNRWA urges the international community and all warring parties to develop humanitarian corridors that particularly safeguard individuals with disabilities who otherwise become victims due to their apparent liabilities. These actions must include-	75
4. Mandatory Corridor Notification Protocol-	75
5. EU Union Resettlement and Humanitarian Admission Framework Regulation 2024/1350-	75
6. UN Security Council 2730 Resolution-	76
7. UN General Assembly Resolution-	76
8. ICJ Provisional Measures Order (January 2024) -	76

9. Obligatory Extension of UNRWA-	76
10. Mandatory Rehabilitation Protocol on Conflict-	77
11. Independent Vetting and Neutrality Certification Mechanism to Humanitarian Agencies-	77
12. Rehabilitation Framework of Palestinian Refugee Children-	77
13. The World Health Organization (WHO) requests governments and humanitarian organizations to-	77
14. The United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA) requests all Member States, host nations and conflicting parties to take the following actions-	78
15. The United Nations Security Council (UNSC) needs to create a distinct Humanitarian Corridor Protection Mechanism through its UN Security Council General Assembly Resolution-	78
16. Creation of a Binding “Humanitarian Access Guarantee Clause” in Ceasefire Agreements-	79
17. The United Nations should establish the Neutral Humanitarian Air Bridge System, which needs to begin operating its humanitarian flights at least five times each day to deliver essential supplies to areas which remain unreachable because of active warfare-	79
18. Formation of an International “Humanitarian Corridor Coordination Task Force (HCCTF)-	79
9. Country-specific Action	81
10. Questions a Resolution must answer	84
11. Bibliography	86

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

Letter from the Executive Board

Greetings, Delegates!

We warmly welcome you all to this session of the Advisory Commission of the UNRWA, as we come together to discuss and deliberate on the important issue of safeguarding humanitarian corridors and upholding neutrality and international law. This agenda and its relevance are something that the international community has neglected for many years, and we must discuss the presence of active conflict zones in the world today.

The condition of Palestinians in the Near East is a blatant example of torture and ethnic cleansing being undertaken under the guise of countering violent religious extremism in the Middle East today. Their predicament serves as a stark reminder of the critical need for international action to defend human rights and ensure that offenders are held accountable. A more just and equitable society depends on your active involvement in this committee; therefore, we want you to contribute your thoughts, knowledge, and viewpoints on these crucial topics.

Collectively, we can work towards identifying the root causes of innumerable human rights violations that occur during the humanitarian crises prevalent today, especially with respect to how they manifest themselves with regard to the different conflict zones present today, thereby contributing to the creation of a more collaborative and cooperative international society.

Together, we aim to provide a positive, welcoming environment where you may listen to and weigh a range of opinions, while expressing your own. We are confident that your involvement will make this committee meeting much more successful.

Thank you for your commitment to human rights and your readiness to take on this significant task. We look forward to seeing your meaningful participation.

In case of any doubts, feel free to reach out to us at: unrwa2026.smun@gmail.com

Sincerely,

Advisory Commission of the UNRWA

Meet the Executive Board



“Everyone breathes in air, but it’s a wise person who knows when to use that air to speak and when to exhale in silence.”

- Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni

Greetings delegates,

The crispness of the air, the raising of placards, the sight of wrinkled paper and the curiosity and vivacity in the eyes of every delegate are what have truly made MUNs such an endearing part of my school life for the past 6 years. First as a delegate and now as a Director, I have come to realise that MUNs truly represent something far more than just awards or trophies. They provide us with an opportunity to develop true character, inculcate

the habit of in-depth research and ignite the spirit of diplomacy, cooperation and compassion. But most of all, what has made me realise the profundity of this journey is the fact that I possess the ability to share it with all of you through this letter.

I am Aishani Purohit, a student of grade 12, currently studying Political Science, English, Psychology, Economics and Maths. My study of these subjects, however, is incomplete without Hindi/Punjabi music in the background and a bowl of Maggi on the side. But what I love to do the most is interacting with people. The conversations we have and the stories we learn about provide us with insights into innumerable life experiences. Experiences that teach us about the commonalities among us and the interconnectedness of our lives. This is the very purpose of the forum of the Model United Nations.

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

MUNs offer not simply platforms for us to voice our opinions, but also to get closer towards understanding the very nature of geopolitical conflicts and the uncertainty with which certain individuals are forced to lead their lives. This is more pertinent than ever when the world finds itself in the midst of a humanitarian crisis that has rattled the very foundations of the United Nations and shared humanity.

The depth and severity of this conflict are reflected not simply by the burning cities and the rubble of buildings, but by the broken cries of young children, men and women, the whimpered whispers of the old and the quagmire of privileged insensitivity and indifference in which the region's politicians are now stuck.

This simulation of the Advisory Commission of the UNRWA will discuss not simply the complexities of the Israel-Palestine conflict, but its byproducts - the instability, the violence, the silencing of opinions and the ushering in of an era of chaos and uncertainty. In the process, you will learn to understand the plight of the Palestinian people and will learn to acknowledge and attempt to undo the irreparable damage that has plagued the Middle East today.

Delegates, the responsibility of providing solutions to the crisis and thus providing the Palestinian people with the peace they deserve lies on your shoulders.

To our land,
and it is the one surrounded with torn hills,
the ambush of a new past

To our land, and it is a prize of war,
the freedom to die from longing and burning
and our land, in its bloodied night,
is a jewel that glimmers for the far upon the far
and illuminates what's outside it ...

As for us, inside,

We suffocate more! (To Our Land, by Mahmoud Darwish)

Feel free to reach out in case of any doubts. I hope this 3-day conference proves to be memorable for all of you.

All the best!

Aishani Purohit

Director, UNRWA, Inter SMUN 2026



unrwa
الاونروا

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين



“No one is born hating another person because of the colour of his skin, or his background, or his religion.”

— Nelson Mandela

Humanitarian crises are never driven by natural forces, but are a result of blind prejudice, which leads to the formation of divisions that are learnt, reinforced and weaponised. Political manipulation and exclusion have led to minorities around the world being exposed to violence and deprivation.

Greetings Delegates,

I am Tejas Veer Singh, and I will be serving as a Director of the UNRWA this edition of Inter SMUN. I believe MUNs require delegates who are able to capture their essence by building their speeches and paperwork in the spirit of compromise, collaboration, out-of-the-box thinking and crisis resolution. My first MUN in seventh grade was a blend of nerves and a lot of excitement, but the moment I raised my placard (with a little encouragement from my friends) for my first speech, I knew I was hooked. Ever since then, to my latest conference, MUNs have been characterised by intense debates, late-night research sessions and negotiations with my fellow delegates. I look forward to seeing the same energy and enthusiasm from all of you.

Outside of MUNs, I have a keen interest in sports, travelling and the sciences. I periodically spend time listening to music and flipping through biographies. Whether it's reading about sporting legends or exploring new places, I believe in always expanding one's horizons. My interest in debating eventually got me to the Humanitarian Committee. This committee stood apart from others for me because of its nature of prioritising people over politics. This session of Inter SMUN, UNRWA is tasked with coordinating with various humanitarian agencies and establishing corridors that ensure the safe travel of essential goods and act as a safe

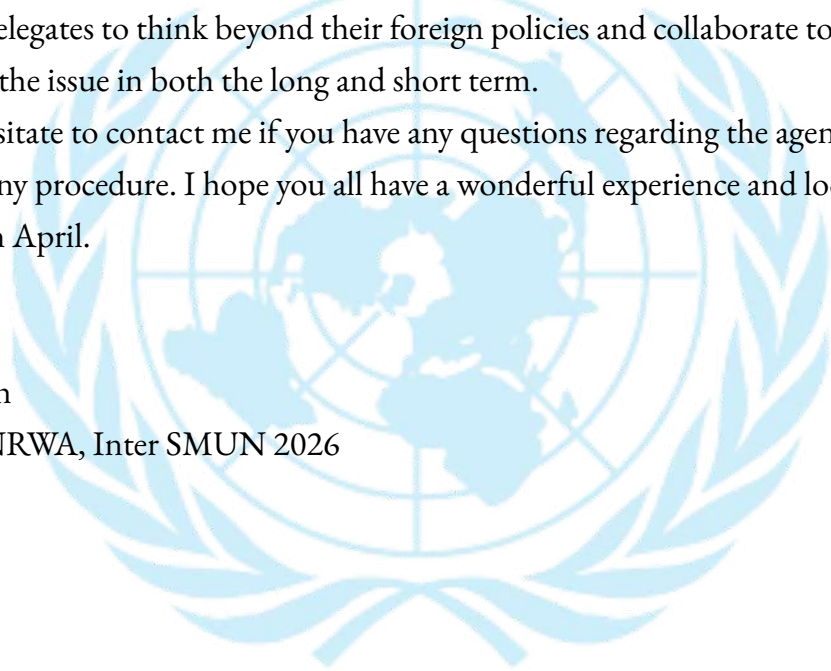
way to evacuate civilians and refugees. As we move into another session of Inter SMUN, I encourage all delegates to think beyond their foreign policies and collaborate to find solutions that will tackle the issue in both the long and short term.

Please don't hesitate to contact me if you have any questions regarding the agenda, the committee or any procedure. I hope you all have a wonderful experience and look forward to seeing you all in April.

Sincerely

Tejas Veer Singh

Director of UNRWA, Inter SMUN 2026



unrwa
الأونروا

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين



"Hard work without talent is a shame, but talent without hard work is a tragedy." —

Robert Half

Greetings Delegates!

My name is Divispruk Kapoor, and I am honoured to serve as your additional director for the humanitarian committee at Inter SMUN-2026. I can assure you that I will try my utmost best to make this committee as memorable and enjoyable as possible.

Currently, I am a Grade 11 Science student focusing on Physics, Chemistry, Maths and Economics. In the future, I intend to pursue finance and earn a lot of money. Outside the classroom, you would find me near the sports field playing football with my friends or talking about Lamine Yamal's and Pedri's crazy dribbling skills. I am also interested in many other sports such as Table Tennis, Swimming and Lawn Tennis. Apart from sports, I usually spend my time talking to my friends, listening to music or worrying about being too unproductive.

I am eager to try new things because life is all about learning and exploring. In fact, it was this mindset and a close friend's constant persuading that led me to my first MUN in 9th Grade. Many of my friends used to do a lot of MUNs, whilst I, on the other hand, had no clue about what they truly were and why people were so excited and engaged in them. I didn't understand why everyone addressed each other as 'delegates' and were so formal as if they were actual dignitaries. During my first MUN, I was a shy and socially awkward person, terrified of giving opening speeches, answering POIs and lobbying others. Since then, I have attended multiple conferences, which have helped me significantly improve my knowledge and skills. Soon, I became a lot more confident. I learnt that they are really important and actually help you develop life skills such as quick thinking and being confident. Though I would say the most

important thing I learnt from my MUN experience was how to initiate and engage in conversations with others, which I believe are essential skills every individual should develop. I realised life revolves around human interaction, and Model United Nations honours these abilities exceptionally well.

My first committee was a humanitarian one, and I only joined because my friend, who was applying to the same committee, encouraged me to sign up. Later, he switched to another committee, but something from that first humanitarian experience resonated deeply with me, inspiring me to stay. I believe it's one of the most enjoyable committees, offering delegates the fullest and most realistic MUN experience. I welcome all of you delegates into the United Nations Relief and Works Agency at INTER SMUN '2026 to help find Palestinian refugees in the Near East a proper solution for all forms of violence in active conflict zones.

The stakes? Lives on the line. Aid corridors shatter in conflict zones. Palestinian refugees in the Near East wait no more. Neutrality is carved in stone. Law wields the axe. Violence meets its end.

Will you be the shield that saves them, or the silence that buries them? Choose wisely.

Regards,
Divispruk Kapoor,
Additional Director,
SMUN 2026

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين



"Humanitarian action is not a political choice; it is a legal and moral obligation to provide a space for humanity amidst the chaos of war." — Geneva Convention.

Greetings Delegates!

SMUN is more than just a "Model United Nations". For some, it is a way to express themselves, for others it is a means of becoming future leaders, and for people like me, it is a passionate hobby that pushes us to achieve our potential.

I am Aryav Sachan, a grade 11th student studying Physics, Chemistry, Maths and Computer Science, who began his MUN journey back in grade 7. From

trying out a hand from the Indian Committee, to even the UNSC and then finally to the Humanitarian Committee, MUN is a powerful catalyst for developing strategic thinking, our ability to create comprehensive solutions, and creates an essential bridge between theoretical knowledge and leadership.

Today, in the 14th edition of the Sanskriti Model United Nations, as we simulate the Advisory Commission of the UNRWA and address not only the instability of Palestinian refugees but also the critical need for Safeguarding Humanitarian Corridors in Active Conflict Zones, we come at crossroads where we must decide between politicization of aid to dismantle the only lifeline for refugees or to reinforce the legal and moral sanctity of the humanitarian corridor. As delegates sitting in a committee that holds the power to change the course of millions of people, and as representatives of global nations, the committee must rise above the rhetoric of condemnation and provide solutions that bring change in conditions of refugees all around the world, that re instills the faith in the "blue flag" that generations of refugees have seen as a sanctuary for temporary relief but today, burns in the fire. Representing the UNRWA, the delegates must not only answer the crossroads that the international community finds itself in

but deliberate the very foundations of the Geneva Conventions that lie in jeopardy as the world fails to safeguard the delivery of flour, water, medicine and education.

Yours truly,

Aryav Sachan

Additional Director

Advisory Commission of the UNRWA

INTER SMUN, 2026



unrwa
الأونروا

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين



Don't count the words spoken, make every word count through the lives we change.

Greetings Delegates and Changemakers,

This quote captures the essence of what the humanitarian committee truly stands for. It's never about how much we speak, how long speeches are or how much we use bold policies and laws. Every word, every effort and every action of yours should solely stand for making the lives of the underprivileged and ill-treated into something better and meaningful.

I, Avyukt Prasad, am no less than glad to be serving as your Additional Director for InterSMUN'26, not because of the title, but because I firmly believe that while many shape committees, it's ultimately the delegates who shape the director. I'm someone who thrives as a passionate debater, drummer, orator, actor (only an amateur!) and a more or less funny person.

While many people say they're afraid of their first MUN(I was too), I want all of the delegates, the first timers and the usuals, reading this to know that this conference is not about shouting out loud, rehearsed speeches or safe opinions. This conference is for you to listen, respond, think and come to a consensus that solves the crisis at hand. Many times, a Humanitarian Committee has good arguments and questions, but most of the time, it also lacks the actions that can be taken to heal real people. Empathy matters as much as evidence, and responsibility matters as much as policy.

The key thing I want you to take away from this conference is that humanitarian diplomacy isn't about being right, it's about being accountable.

And if you've made it this far, I'd like to say thank you. I do know that most delegates don't always read the EB letters in their entirety, but the fact that you did already says something about the kind of delegate you'll be in committee.

When this conference ends, I hope you leave not just as better delegates, but as more aware individuals who are ready to make every word count where it truly matters.

Come prepared. Come curious. Come bold.
And most importantly, come human.

I look forward to seeing you in committee!

Best Regards,
Avyukt Prasad
Additional Director, Humanitarian Committee

unrwa
الأونروا

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

Letter from the President of the UNRWA

(to the Secretary-General for a temporary change in committee composition)

United Nations Relief and Works Agency
for Palestine Refugees in the Near East.

Office of the President

P.O. Box 140157, Amman 11814

To: The Secretary-General

United Nations Headquarters

New York, NY

Subject: Adjustment in Committee
Composition for the Special Session
scheduled for April 23-25

Dear Secretary General

I hope this letter finds you well. I am
writing this notice to inform you of the
following changes in the committee
composition of the UNRWA, effective
from April 23-25:

UNRWA and will be given
membership status for this specific
session.

- I. Arab Republic of Egypt
- II. Republic of Iraq
- III. Hashemite Kingdom of Jordan
- IV. State of Kuwait
- V. Lebanese Republic
- VI. State of Qatar
- VII. Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
- VIII. Syrian Arab Republic United Arab Emirates
- IX. Kingdom of Bahrain
- X. Federal Republic of Somalia
- XI. Republic of the Sudan
- XII. Republic of Yemen
- XIII. State of Libya People's
- XIV. Democratic Republic of Algeria
- XV. Republic of the Union of Myanmar
- XVI. State of Palestine
- XVII. Federation of Malaysia (small contributions reported in appeals but not in the core donor list)
- XVIII. Republic of Indonesia
- XIX. Federal Republic of Nigeria
- XX. Kingdom of Morocco
- XXI. Czech Republic
- XXII. Hungary

- 1) The Republic of Kazakhstan has agreed to give up their membership status for the upcoming special session.
- 2) The following countries have been invited to this special session of the

- XXIII. Republic of Bulgaria
- XXIV. Sultanate of Oman
- XXV. Islamic Republic of Iran
- XXVI. Republic of South Africa
- XXVII. Republic of Colombia
- XXVIII. Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela
- XXIX. Republic of Cuba
- XXX. United Mexican States
- XXXI. Argentine Republic
- XXXII. Eastern Republic of Uruguay
- XXXIII. People's Republic Of China
- XXXIV. Russian Federation
- XXXV. State of Israel
- XXXVI. Islamic Republic of Pakistan
- XXXVII. Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan
- XXXVIII. Republic of Korea
- XXXIX. Portuguese Republic

23-25. It has been undertaken to ensure effective representation of all parties involved in the issue at hand.

The Office of the President remains fully committed to working in close coordination with the Secretariat to ensure that all procedural requirements are duly observed. Should any further clarification or documentation be required, we remain at your disposal.

Yours Sincerely



Philippe Lazzarini
President of the UNRWA

I would like to reiterate that this expansion is temporary and only in effect from April

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

About the committee

The United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA) is a humanitarian organisation founded in 1949 to provide aid and protection to Palestinian refugees. It was established in response to widespread displacement post-conflict in the region. UNRWA has since become one of the largest and most important humanitarian organisations in the world. The organisation provides essential aid such as education, primary healthcare, shelter, and emergency relief to millions of Palestinian refugees living across the Near East.

UNRWA, apart from providing immediate relief, also plays a crucial role in supporting human development and social stability within the refugee settlements. Educational initiatives serve over 5,00,000 students in over 700 schools in the Middle East, while

services such as primary healthcare help tackle the frequent challenges faced by the vulnerable populations. Many of the areas where UNRWA operates are affected by political unrest and economic instability, which can significantly hinder humanitarian efforts. These areas include Jordan, Lebanon, Syria, the Gaza Strip and the West Bank, including East Jerusalem.

As a humanitarian committee, UNRWA upholds the principles of neutrality and impartiality that guide international aid efforts. UNRWA is not only a relief organisation, but also a long-term stabilising force for displaced communities, even in the face of ongoing challenges, including a lack of financial resources and operational constraints.

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

1. Statement of the Problem

1.1 What are Humanitarian Corridors?

Humanitarian corridors, often referred to as "**safe passages**" or "**relief corridors**" are temporarily negotiated and legally mandated routes or zones within active conflicts. They are essentially agreements between parties involved in armed conflicts and serve to fulfil:

1. Safe passage for a limited time in a specific geographic area
2. Evacuation of civilians from areas of intense fighting
3. Humanitarian assistance and provision of other essential needs
4. Access for medical and humanitarian personnel (ICRC, UN agencies, NGOs) to allow evacuation of the wounded, sick or dead
5. Temporary ceasefires localised to specific geographic passages

The integrity of such corridors, however, depends on all warring parties respecting the corridor's designated boundaries and timing.

While the exact number of humanitarian corridors that have been established remains uncertain, an approximate value of nearly 100 humanitarian corridors has been documented by various humanitarian organisations. A few prominent examples include:

1. **Spanish Civil War (1936–1939):**

Following the attacks on Madrid beginning in November 1936, the ICRC obtained authorisation in July 1937 to evacuate women, children, and elderly people to Valencia. Constituting the first humanitarian corridor, the humanitarian access operations were partially respected and thus partially successful.

2. **Sudan (Operation Lifeline**

Sudan) (1989): Humanitarian corridors established during this time period, meant to guarantee the safe delivery and impartial distribution of aid by air and road.

Yet, access was inconsistent, with

periodic disruptions from both Sudanese Government forces and the Sudan People's Liberation Army (SPLA).

3. **Gaza / Israel– Hamas War**

(2023–present): These largely violated humanitarian corridors, although established with the intention of assisting civilians, have instead been utilised and taken advantage of to move personnel or military supplies.

While humanitarian corridors remain effective in well-defined operations, the general pattern, however, highlights their inability to function effectively in the case of large-scale conflicts.

1.2 How many active conflict zones and types of violence?

The current scenario regarding the forms of violence and presence of active conflict zones is widespread. Currently, nearly 14 active conflict zones have been identified throughout the world, and 6 prominent conflict regions have been listed below:

Major Wars/ Active conflict zones					
S. No	Conflict Zone	Type of Violence	Main Parties	Intensity	Civilian Impact
1.	Russia – Ukraine	Interstate conventional war	Russia vs. Ukraine (+ NATO support)	Extreme	10M+ displaced
2.	Gaza – Israel	Asymmetric conflict, Siege warfare, urban combat	Israel vs. Hamas (+ Palestinian factions)	Extreme	2.2M in Gaza
3.	Sudan Civil War	Civil war, Ethnic violence	SAF (army) vs. RSF (paramilitary)	Extreme	Approx. 12M displaced
4.	Yemen War	Proxy civil war, famine weaponisation	Houthis vs. Saudi-led coalition	High	21M need aid
5.	Syria (Ongoing Violence)	Post-civil war insurgency, factional armed clashes, terrorism	SDF, HTS, Turkish-backed factions, ISIS remnants	High	Approx. 7M displaced
6.	USA Israel – Iran War	Interstate war	USA + Israel vs. Iran + Hezbollah + Iran-backed militias	Extreme	1,300+ killed in Iran; 570+ in Lebanon

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

1.3 Humanitarian Laws-

International Humanitarian Laws, often also referred to as Laws of War, form the basis of humanitarian corridors. Key humanitarian laws that remain relevant include:

1. Geneva Conventions (1949) & Additional Protocols (1977)

- a. Article 70, AP I: Mandates parties to provide humanitarian aid and allow humanitarian relief operations during times when civilians lack essential supplies
- b. Common Article 3: Prohibits violence against those not actively fighting, including civilians, medical personnel etc., even in non-international armed conflicts
- c. Article 23, GC IV: Mandates the state to allow free passage of medical and humanitarian aid and supplies to the general population

2. Customary International Humanitarian Law:

- a. Rule 55: Parties must allow the rapid inflow of humanitarian aid. Although confused with Article 70, AP

1, the Customary IHL Rule 55 remains applicable and binding on all parties and all conflicts, irrespective of ratification of Additional Protocol Rule I

- b. Rule 56: All humanitarian personnel must be respected and protected.
- c. Rule 31: All humanitarian workers must be distinguished and never directly targeted.

3. Rome Statute of the ICC (1998):

Classifies deliberate impeding of humanitarian relief and/or attacking humanitarian personnel as a **war crime** under Article 8.

1.4 Neutrality & Establishing Trust in Humanitarian Operations-

Humanitarian organisations operate through core principles of neutrality, impartiality, and independence, which the International Committee of the Red Cross and International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies use to access conflict-affected populations while executing their humanitarian missions.

(I) Trust Deficits in the Palestinian Refugee Situation:

The Palestinian refugee situation presents unique challenges in maintaining neutrality and trust. The United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA), established in 1949, functions exclusively to serve Palestinian refugees, which distinguishes it from other refugee organisations that operate under international frameworks. The distinct structure has created political sensitivities, which lead to perceptions of partiality that damage trust between the different stakeholder groups.

A. Multi-Level Trust Deficits:

1. Host Country Policies and Perceptions

The countries of Lebanon, Jordan and Syria maintain large Palestinian refugee populations while implementing different levels of restrictions to control their movements. The Lebanese government prohibits Palestinian workers from certain jobs and restricts their ability to own property. The policies create trust deficits because they shape how people view both refugees and humanitarian workers.

2. Political Developments and Aid Conditionality

Peace process failures have included multiple attempts, which all ended in

failure, and this created scepticism among the affected groups. The United States suspension of UNRWA funding in 2018 created major concerns about humanitarian aid being used for political purposes. Trust deficits have continued even after funding restoration in 2021.

3. Operational and Neutrality Concerns

Multiple donor countries stopped funding operations after Israel accused UNRWA employees of participating in the October 7 attacks. The essential services which provide support to nearly 6 million registered Palestinian refugees suffered interruptions because of this. The current situation demonstrates that organizations need to maintain their designated operational boundaries because any perceived violation will create adverse effects on their humanitarian work and funding operations.

(II) Effective Global Practices for Building Trust

1. Use of Monitoring and Notification Systems

Humanitarian organisations in conflict areas like South Sudan and Syria have deployed GPS-based notification systems, which enable them to track aid convoy

movements. The United Nations Department of Safety and Security and other organisations operate these systems to achieve two main goals, which include decreasing accidental military strikes and enhancing operational activity visibility.

2. Community-Based Humanitarian Standards

The Sphere Association standards establish frameworks which require humanitarian organisations to show responsibility towards their beneficiaries while they engage affected communities in their relief efforts. The organisation establishes trust with local residents through this method, which matches humanitarian aid delivery to their actual community requirements.

3. Localisation of Humanitarian Aid

The World Humanitarian Summit 2016 started initiatives which aim to raise financial resources while enhancing operational assistance for indigenous organizations. The Palestine Red Crescent Society provides essential humanitarian services through its established relationships of trust, which it maintains with local people.

4. Humanitarian Diplomacy and Neutral Engagement

The International Committee of the Red Cross establishes confidential bilateral discussions with each conflict party to enable its humanitarian activities. The method protects operational independence by refraining from public identification with either group while simultaneously maintaining the organization's designated neutral status.

1.5 Palestinian Refugees in the Near East & the Israel-Palestine Conflict-

Back then, in 1948, around 750,000 Palestinians left their homes - some ran, others were forced out - amid fighting between Arab states and Israel. When approximately 750,000 Palestinians fled or were expelled during the Arab-Israeli War, Palestinians called it the Nakba ("catastrophe"). Afterwards came chaos. To help, the United Nations stepped in, creating UNRWA just for Palestinian refugees, one year later. This setup stands apart - no other displaced group has its own special agency outside the global refugee body. Here's what shifts numbers: unlike standard rules, UNRWA counts children, grandchildren, and even great-grandchildren as refugees too. Because of that choice, millions more appear on the list today. What began with three-quarters of a million souls now

includes nearly six million names spread through Gaza, the West Bank, Jordan, Lebanon, and Syria.

Different countries in the Near East treat Palestinian refugees in different ways. Jordan has given citizenship to many Palestinians, more than any other country. Lebanon stands apart - life for Palestinians there is tough due to tight restrictions. Owning land was also not allowed. This setup comes from worries about changing the country's makeup. Before 2011, Syria was home to a strong Palestinian presence. Then war shattered neighborhoods such as Yarmouk, forcing people to flee again. Nowhere offers full rights. Nowhere treats them as regular residents. They fall between categories - not nationals, not covered by usual refugee rules. Their survival is directly linked to whether UNRWA keeps operating.

The crisis hits hardest in Gaza. Since 2007, an Israeli-Egyptian blockade has sealed off the area; meanwhile, Hamas holds control. Around 2.3 million individuals survive there, more than fifty per cent listed as refugees. Conditions were so severe that the UN labels them unlivable - again and again. On October 7, 2023, violence erupted when Hamas launched attacks; Israel

responded with a sweeping military operation. By 2024, some areas in northern Gaza faced outright starvation - declared so by the IPC. This unfolding disaster now ranks among the gravest humanitarian breakdowns seen in decades.

What keeps this crisis going after seven decades isn't aid shortages - it's politics. Back in 1948, UN General Assembly Resolution 194 affirmed that Palestinian refugees could go home - though they never got the chance.

Plans were drawn up aiming at a self-governing Palestine but little came of them. Across the occupied West Bank today, well over seven hundred thousand settlers have made homes - expansion deemed illegal by the International Court of Justice near the start of 2024. While progress halts, aid workers pass out food and basics; people without a country remain as they are. With leaders unable to move forward, UNRWA keeps going - extended once more, then once more after that. Stuck in that icy pause, each aid mission plays out to an end. Shifts never happen - only loops remain.

2. Timeline

(Sourced from the official website of the United Nations)

1. **1885:** The term “Zionism” first coined by the Viennese writer, Nathan Birnbaum.
2. **1896:** Theodor Herzl, founder of the Zionist movement, calls for “restoration of the Jewish State”.
3. **1897:** The first Zionist Congress takes place in Basel, Switzerland, and the first Zionist organization is founded.
4. **1907:** Zionist leader Chaim Weizmann visits Palestine.
5. **1908:** First Palestinian anti-Zionist weekly newspaper was published by Arab Christian Najib Nassar.
6. **1915:** British cabinet member Herbert Samuel calls for the British annexation of Palestine in the memorandum “The Future of Palestine”.
7. **1916:** European Powers conclude the secret Sykes-Picot agreement dividing future spheres of influence in Ottoman Empire territories.
8. **1917:** The Balfour Declaration promises a “national home for the Jewish people in Palestine”.
9. **1919:** Emir Feisal presents a memorandum to the Paris Peace Conference, outlining the case for the independence of Arab countries.
10. **1922:** The League of Nations grants mandate over former Ottoman territory of Palestine to the UK. Provisions include terms of the Balfour Declaration, including a “Jewish national home”.
11. **1933:** Palestinians riot amid a sudden rise in Jewish immigration from Nazi persecution in Germany.
12. **1936-1939:** Palestinian rebellion against the British Mandate and Jewish immigration.
13. **1937:** UK Peel Commission Report publicly recognizes the conflict’s irreconcilable terms and recommends partition of Palestine.
14. **1939:** The UK issues White Paper limiting Jewish immigration.
15. **1942:** US Zionists meet in NY and adopt the “Biltmore Programme”, calling for the establishment of Palestine as a Jewish

Commonwealth and for unlimited immigration.

16. **1947:** In February, the UK proposes to relinquish its mandatory role and places the question of Palestine before the UN. In September, the UN Special Committee on Palestine (UNSCOP) issued a report to the General Assembly with plans for partition or a federal state in Palestine. In November, the UN General Assembly adopted resolution 181(II), which called for the division of Palestine into an unnamed “Jewish State” and an unnamed “Arab State” with Jerusalem under UN trusteeship.

17. **APRIL 1948:** Deir Yassin massacre: Zionist paramilitary groups kill hundreds of Palestinian Arabs in Deir Yassin, a village near Jerusalem.

18. **MAY 1948:** Great Britain terminates the Mandate over Palestine, and Israel declares independence on 15 May. First large-scale displacement of Palestinian refugees; 15 May becomes an official day to mark the *Palestinian Nakba* (“catastrophe”). The first Arab-Israeli War broke out when five Arab nations – Egypt,

Transjordan (Jordan), Iraq, Syria, and Lebanon – invaded firstly the areas in southern and eastern Palestine not apportioned to the Jewish State by the UN partition of Palestine, and later, East Jerusalem. Count Folke Bernadotte appointed UN Mediator in Palestine by the UN General Assembly. He is assassinated four months later by a Zionist militant group. The Security Council establishes a group of military observers to supervise the truce, which later became UNTSO.

19. **NOVEMBER 1948:** UN establishes a special fund to provide relief to over 500,000 Palestinian refugees.

20. **DECEMBER 1948:** UN General Assembly passes resolution 194 calling for refugees to be allowed to return, Jerusalem to be under an international regime, and the UN Conciliation Commission for Palestine (UNCCP) replaces UN mediator.

21. **FEBRUARY-JULY 1949:** Israel signs armistice agreements with Egypt, Jordan, Lebanon and Syria.

22. **APRIL 1949:** UN Conciliation Commission convenes Lausanne Conference to reconcile the parties.

- 
23. **MAY 1949:** UNGA adopts Resolution 273 (III) admitting Israel as a UN member.
24. **DECEMBER 1949:** UN establishes UNRWA to replace UNRPR (GA Resolution 302 (IV)).
25. **1950:** Israel moves its capital from Tel Aviv to the western part of Jerusalem, in defiance of UN resolutions, and the West Bank is brought formally under Jordanian control.
26. **1964:** Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) is founded in Cairo.
27. **1967:** Six-Day War: Israel occupies the West Bank, including East Jerusalem, Gaza, Golan Heights, and Sinai Peninsula. In November, the UN Security Council unanimously adopted Resolution 242 (Land for Peace).
28. **1968:** Establishment of a UN Special Committee to Investigate Israeli Practices Affecting the Human Rights of the Palestinian People and Other Arabs of the Occupied Territories.
29. **1973:** Following the Middle East war of October, the UN Security Council passes resolution 338 calling for a ceasefire, implementation of res. 242, negotiations between parties.
30. **1974:** The UN General Assembly and the Arab League recognize the PLO as the sole legitimate representative of the Palestinian people.
31. General Assembly reaffirms inalienable rights of Palestinian people to self-determination, independence and sovereignty, and refugee return (resolution 3236).
32. **1975:** In 1975, the Committee on the Exercise of the Inalienable Rights of the Palestinian People (CEIRPP) was founded by Resolution 3376 of the UNGA.
33. **1976:** The CEIRPP submits its programme to the Security Council and General Assembly to enable Palestinians to exercise their inalienable rights.
34. **1977:** Pursuant to UNGA Resolution 32/40 B, International Day of Solidarity with the Palestinian People is celebrated annually on 29 November.
35. **1978:** Following two weeks of secret negotiations at Camp David (USA), the Egyptian President and the Israeli Prime Minister agree on a Framework for Peace in the Middle East.

- 
36. **1979:** The UNGA redesignates the Special Unit on Palestinian Rights as the Division for Palestinian Rights (Resolution 34/65 D).
37. **1980:** Israeli Knesset enacts the so-called 'Basic Law' on Jerusalem, proclaiming that "Jerusalem, whole and united" is the capital of Israel; the Security Council and GA resolution 35/169 E censure this law.
38. **1981:** UNESCO adds the Old City of Jerusalem to the UNESCO World Heritage Site list. UN Security Council adopts resolution 497, calling on Israel to rescind its action to annex the Golan Heights.
39. **1982:** Israel invades Lebanon with the intention of eliminating the PLO. After a ceasefire, PLO forces withdraw to neighboring countries. Despite guarantees of safety for Palestinian refugees left behind, there are massacres at Sabra and Shatila camps.
40. **1987:** First "Intifada" begins in the Jabaliya Refugee Camp in the Gaza Strip.
41. **1988:** In July, Jordan renounces claims to the West Bank and recognizes PLO as "the sole legitimate representative of the Palestinian people." In November, in Algiers, the Palestinian National Council adopts the declaration of independence of the State of Palestine. In December, PLO Chair Yasser Arafat addressed the UN in Geneva; said Palestine National Council accepts UNSC Resolutions 242 and 338.
42. **1991:** The Middle East peace conference in Madrid brings together all the parties to the Arab-Israeli conflict.
43. **1993:** Israel and the PLO sign the Declaration of Principles on Interim Self-Government Arrangements, also known as the Oslo Accords. Several "permanent status" issues are deferred for future negotiations.
44. **1994:** The Office of the UN Special Coordinator in the Occupied Territories (UNSCO) is established, and Mr. Terje Roed-Larsen of Norway is appointed as the first UN Special Coordinator.
45. **1995:** Israel and the PLO sign the Palestinian-Israeli Interim Agreement on the West Bank and the Gaza Strip ("Oslo II").
46. **1996:** Palestinian general elections are held.
47. **1997:** Israel and the PLO sign the Hebron Protocol.

48. **1998:** Israel and the PLO sign the Wye River Memorandum, which consists of steps to facilitate implementation of previous agreements.
49. **2000:** In July, the US President Clinton convenes a Middle East Peace Summit at Camp David, which concludes without agreement. Ariel Sharon's visit to al-Haram al-Sharif in September 2000 triggered the Second Palestinian Intifada.
50. **2001:** Outgoing US President Clinton proposes the Clinton Parameters for a permanent status agreement to resolve the Israeli-Palestinian conflict. Shortly afterwards, the Taba Summit is held between Israel and the Palestinian Authority but fails to resolve the "permanent status" issues.
51. **2002:** The UN Security Council passes resolution 1397 affirming the vision of a two-State solution to the conflict. The Quartet, consisting of the UN, the EU, the US, and Russia is established with a mandate to help mediate the Israeli-Palestinian conflict and support Palestinian economic development and institution-building. During a summit in Beirut, the League of Arab States adopted the Arab Peace Initiative.
52. **2003:** Roadmap for Peace is published by the Quartet and is endorsed by the Security Council in resolution 1515.
53. **2004:** The International Court of Justice (ICJ) issues an Advisory Opinion on the legality of the construction of a wall in the Occupied Palestinian Territory.
54. **2006:** In January, Hamas wins Palestinian Legislative Elections; forms Palestinian Authority government. The Quartet responds with the Quartet Principles. In July, Israel went to war with Hezbollah in Lebanon.
55. **2007:** Israel imposes a blockade on the Gaza Strip after an armed takeover of Gaza by Hamas. In November, the Annapolis Conference ended with parties issuing a joint statement committing to immediately implement their respective obligations under the Roadmap and working towards a peace treaty by the end of 2008.
56. **2008:** Israel broadens its sanctions and completely seals off the Gaza Strip. Later in the year, Israel launches "Operation Cast Lead", a

- 22-day military assault on the Gaza Strip.
57. **2009:** Security Council passes resolution 1860 calling for a ceasefire in Gaza. HRC created the UN Fact-Finding Mission on the Gaza conflict to investigate violations of international humanitarian and human rights law. Their findings are issued in the “Goldstone Report”.
58. **2012:** In November, Israel launches ‘Pillar of Defense’, an 8-day military operation against the Gaza Strip. Later that month, the General Assembly adopted resolution 67/19, granting Palestine the status of non-member observer State in the UN.
59. **2013:** Direct negotiations between Israel and Palestine are held following an initiative by US Secretary of State John Kerry to restart the peace process.
60. **2014:** Israel launches a large-scale military operation codenamed “Protective Edge” in the Gaza Strip.
61. **2016:** UN Security Council adopts resolution 2334, stating that Israel’s settlement activity constitutes a “flagrant violation” of international law and has “no legal validity”.
62. **2017:** US President Trump announces that the United States would recognize Jerusalem as the capital of Israel.
63. **2018:** US embassy in Israel moved from Tel Aviv to Jerusalem.
64. **2020:** US President Trump helps mediate Abraham Accords to normalize Israel’s relations with some Arab States and proposes a Peace Plan.
65. **2022:** General Assembly adopts resolution A/RES/77/23 requesting the Committee to commemorate the Nakba for the first time in the history of the UN.
66. **2023:** Israel launches “Operation Swords of Iron” against Gaza following Hamas attack. South Africa initiates a genocide case against Israel at the ICJ.
67. **2024:** International Court of Justice Advisory Opinion declares the Israeli occupation unlawful. The General Assembly demands an end to occupation in 12 months.

3. Current Situation

3.1 Current status of refugees-

Defined as “persons whose normal place of residence was Palestine during the period 1 June 1946 to 15 May 1948, and who lost both home and means of livelihood as a result of the 1948 conflict”, the condition of Palestinian refugees remains critical and alarming

Palestinian refugees are concentrated in five principal operational areas for UNRWA:

1. **Gaza Strip:** Nearly 1.7 million registered refugees populate the Gaza Strip, thus making it one of the most densely populated territories on earth. Subject to a land, air, and sea blockade since 2007, the conditions of Palestinian refugees have been constantly deteriorating primarily due to a total humanitarian blockade that has killed more than 70,000+ refugees. The expulsion of UNRWA, GHF militarized aid distribution and winter crisis have further deteriorated the conditions of living.
2. **West Bank, including East Jerusalem:** Palestinian refugees concentrated in the West Bank face

displacement pressure from settlement expansion and movement restriction. Operation Iron Wall has forced 33,000 refugees to be displaced from Jenin, Nur Shams and Tulkarm camps.

Operation Iron Wall had been a large-scale Israeli military offensive that had been launched in the occupied West Bank on January 21(2025). Involving helicopter gunfire, airstrikes, ground force operations and the deployment of tanks for the first time since the early 2000s. The Human Rights Watch found that Israeli forces had committed forcible displacement in violation of the law of occupation under international humanitarian law, thus resulting in war crimes as well as crimes against humanity under the Rome Statute. Further more than 40,000 Palestinians were forced to leave their homes, with the rate of displacement being the highest since the 1967 Palestinian expulsions.

3. **Jordan:** Containing approximately 2.3 million registered refugees, Jordan hosts the largest population, with a complex legal status since many, despite holding Jordanian citizenship, face diminishing rights due to Palestinian refugee roots.
4. **Lebanon:** Lebanon has 500,000 registered refugees who are denied the right to work in most professions, own property, and are excluded from public health and education systems. With 80%+ below poverty line, four generations of structural exclusion has further adversely impacted the conditions of Palestinian refugees
5. **Syria:** Being severely impacted by the Syrian civil war, Palestinian refugees have become doubly displaced, by fleeing both the conflict and the Palestinian camps that were themselves besieged as well as the Historic Palestine during the 1948/1967 war. With 92% food insecure, the post-Assad return crisis further threatened the existence of Palestinian refugees.
- critical primarily due to the following factors:
1. Imposition of total siege conditions that have resulted in cutting off food, fuel, medicine, and electricity supplies
 2. Disruptions in "safe passage" routes and humanitarian corridors that have resulted in large-scale civilian killing.
 3. The Rafah crossing (Gaza-Egypt border) became a critical and highly contested humanitarian chokepoint
 4. Repeated strikes on UNRWA facilities such as schools and shelters hosting displaced civilians, including;
 - a. On 29 December 2025, Israel passed a law cutting off water, electricity, and fuel to UNRWA facilities and seizing UN properties in East Jerusalem.
 - b. The law effectively stripped UNRWA of its internationally guaranteed legal protections under the Convention on the Privileges and Immunities of the United Nations.
 - c. On 8 December, Israeli forces stormed UNRWA's

Post October 2023 escalation between Israel and Hamas, the condition of Palestinian refugees in Gaza has turned

East Jerusalem compound, confiscated equipment, and replaced the UN flag with an Israeli flag.

has severely restricted humanitarian access.

b. Yemen:

The current situation of humanitarian corridors remains critical, primarily due to the arbitrary detention of Humanitarian personnel by Houthi de facto authorities. With the number touching a total of 69 UN staff held by the Houthis, these detentions have rendered the delivery of humanitarian assistance in Houthi-controlled areas untenable, directly affecting millions of people in need.

a. Sudan:

With more than half of Sudan's population (25 million people) suffering under the burden of acute food insecurity, and with Darfur and Kordofan officially declared to be in famine, the situation in Sudan remains critical due to:

- I. Sudanese authorities and their refusal to grant full permits to the flow of humanitarian assistance, citing security concerns.
- II. The UN has recorded more than 80 attacks on humanitarian convoys since the outbreak of conflict in April 2023, most of them airstrikes coordinated by the Sudanese Air Force.
- III. In Al Fasher (North Darfur), near-daily shelling

c. Ukraine:

Apart from the repeated strikes by Russia, these corridors are also being used as instruments of demographic displacement rather than civilian protection, thus routing evacuations toward Russian or Belarusian territory rather than Ukrainian-controlled zones, which forms in opposition to IHL's voluntary evacuation principles.

d. Near East: Gaza and West Bank

Among all active conflict zones, the Near East represents the most

3.2 Current status of Humanitarian Corridors-

While Humanitarian corridors are established on paper, they are, however violated in practice, and increasingly weaponized by parties to conflict.

thoroughly documented and least acted upon case of humanitarian corridor failure.

On 30 December 2025, Israel banned 37 international NGOs from Gaza and the West Bank on broad and discretionary grounds, including prior engagement with international legal proceedings and association with boycott movements. UN experts officially labelled this a calculated attempt to destroy what's left of the humanitarian infrastructure.

Key operational data reflects the scale of obstruction:

- Between 20 and 26 February 2026, the UN attempted 55 humanitarian missions inside Gaza. Seven were denied outright, 15 faced serious impediments, and only 32 were fully facilitated.
- Between 1 and 17 February 2026, only 296 out of 854 trucks manifested through the Egypt Corridor, representing a 35 per cent success rate.
- Since October 2023, over 500 humanitarian workers and at least 1,500 health

workers have been killed in Gaza.

- UNRWA has been barred from bringing personnel and supplies into Gaza since March 2025, despite having food, flour, and shelter materials prepositioned outside the border sufficient to reach hundreds of thousands of people.

Apart from this, Funding Collapse with Global defence spending reaching \$2.7 trillion in 2024, while the entire humanitarian system remained stagnant at just \$50 billion, has also been a major challenge while ensuring civilian protection and establishment of humanitarian corridors.

3.3 Data-

A) The Current Situation of Palestinian Refugees.

By 2026, over 5.9 million Palestinians will be under UNRWA on the list of refugees. UNRWA Mass displacement has become catastrophic; about 40,000 people were forcibly evicted in Palestine refugee camps in Jenin, Tulkarm, and Nur Shams in January 2025 after operation Iron Wall, the biggest displacement since 1967, and

around 32,400 are in precarious circumstances.

It is estimated that 73,000 displaced individuals are at the moment residing in the UNRWA collective emergency shelters in 83 displacement locations. Living conditions are deplorable in UNRWA. Almost 800,000 residents live in flood-prone areas, and almost 3,500 shelters have been damaged or destroyed between 8 and 15 January 2026 alone, and this has impacted over 19,000 displaced people.

It is the third year in a row that about 658,000 children in Gaza have not received formal in-person education. UNRWA has provided psychosocial assistance sessions to about 730,000 people displaced since the beginning of the war, including more than 520,000 children.

B) Present Situation of Humanitarian Corridors.

As of March 2025, Israeli forces have blocked the direct entry of humanitarian staff and supplies into the Gaza Strip by UNRWA, and the pre-positioning of other supplies, such as food parcels, flour, and shelter materials, which are enough to supply hundreds of thousands of

individuals, is no longer available beyond the Gaza Strip.

All UNRWA international employees are not allowed to enter the occupied Palestinian territory since January 2025, after legislation by the Israeli Knesset barring the activities of UNRWA.

Now, there are 117 UNRWA facilities on the Israeli-militarised territory, and access to them is controlled or coordinated by Israel. Humanitarian infrastructure has been hit many times, including 6 January 2026, when Israeli forces with explosive devices and bulldozers demolished four schools in Jabalia camp, owned by UNRWA.

The International Court of Justice ruled on the legal front that Israel had illegally blocked the delivery of aid, resorted to starvation as a form of warfare and that it had not honored the immunities of UN personnel and premises, demanding that Israel should be left free to allow UNRWA and other UN agencies to operate freely in the Occupied Palestinian Territories.

C) Current Situation of the Palestinian People

The scale of suffering endured by Palestinians since 7 October 2023 is almost

incomprehensible. More than 72,000 people have been killed in the Gaza Strip and over 171,000 injured. In the West Bank, the violence has been no less relentless, with 1,062 Palestinians killed, at least 231 of them children, as settler attacks reached their most intense levels in nearly two decades.

In August 2025, the IPC formally declared famine in Gaza City, a declaration that came too late for the 463 Palestinians, among them 157 children, who had already died of malnutrition by October 2025. These were not deaths from a natural disaster. They were deaths born of deliberate obstruction of blocked trucks, closed crossings, and denied permits. Clean water, once taken for granted, has become a luxury Palestinians can no longer access, as desalination plants were shut down, sewage systems collapsed, and fuel needed to keep generators running was systematically denied entry.

The situation continues to deteriorate. On 28 February 2026, all crossings into Gaza were closed by Israeli authorities, cutting off medical evacuations and choking the last remaining supply lines. In response, the United Nations launched a 2026 Flash Appeal calling for over \$4 billion, a staggering sum that reflects just how total this collapse has become, and how urgently

the international community must act to restore the basic dignities of life to 3.6 million people who have been stripped of almost everything.

3.4 International Situation & UN Response (2025–2026)-

Ceasefire and Its Fragility: A ceasefire was established in October 2025, which resulted in temporary peace between opposing forces who fought in the Gaza Strip. The current situation remains volatile because Israeli military operations have resulted in the deaths of more than 630 Palestinians since the ceasefire started. The West Bank continues to experience violent incidents, which demonstrate that the truce had minimal success in establishing peace.

The ongoing displacement crisis continues throughout the world despite the existence of a ceasefire. The Gaza Strip has experienced population displacement, which has affected approximately 833,000 people. More than 694,000 individuals have relocated from southern areas to northern regions throughout Gaza. This movement demonstrates that people continue to move and that people need assistance.

A. United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the

Near East (UNRWA): Operational Challenges

affects millions of Palestinian refugees.

1. The October 2024 legislative measures which Israel enacted have created operational restrictions which UNRWA now faces. The agency enforced access restrictions on its international personnel starting from January 2025, which included restrictions on humanitarian supply deliveries to Gaza.
2. The Israeli military conducted operations that resulted in extensive damage to UNRWA's primary facility in East Jerusalem in January 2026. The international community expressed strong concern about this situation. The Shu'fat refugee camp and other areas reported interruptions to their water and electricity infrastructure, which caused further problems for their humanitarian work.
3. The local UNRWA staff members continue to provide essential services throughout Gaza. The international staff members who work for the organization and the restricted access to supplies have resulted in major decreases in operational capacity. The situation

B. ICJ Opinion and UN General Assembly Response

The International Court of Justice (ICJ) issued an advisory opinion in October 2025, which required Israel to assist with humanitarian aid distribution through its operations and UNRWA activities.

The United Nations General Assembly passed a resolution in December 2025, which received 139 yes votes and 12 no votes, to demand that countries deal with their international legal duties. The two countries that opposed the resolution were Israel and the United States.

The international legal recommendations have not been fully implemented because enforcement and compliance procedures face significant implementation challenges.

C. NGO Restrictions and Operational Impact

The new regulations, which Israel established in 2025, required international non-governmental organizations (INGOs) to register under specific conditions because of their political advocacy limitations.

The 37 humanitarian organizations which declined to meet these requirements by January 2026 lost their ability to operate in Gaza. This situation has decreased the number of international humanitarian organizations active in the area while putting more operational demands on UNRWA and other organizations.

D. Funding Gaps and Humanitarian Appeals

UNRWA needs USD 1.26 billion in 2026 to provide assistance to 2.4 million residents of Gaza and the West Bank. The World Health Organization (WHO) has established a Humanitarian Health Appeal, which seeks funding of USD 333.2 million.

Both funding appeals face major financial deficiencies, which continue the pattern of funding shortages that has existed since 2007. Humanitarian agencies face difficulties in providing essential services because of these funding deficiencies.

3.5 Israeli policies-

Since 1967, Israel has held authority over the Strip's borders, airspace, and coastline, using closure measures that have choked economic activity and blocked institutional

development within Palestinian-administered areas. On the legal front, Israel has long argued that the Fourth Geneva Convention does not formally apply to the Occupied Palestinian Territory, choosing instead to selectively observe what it calls the Convention's "humanitarian provisions." The ICRC has never accepted this framing. Access restrictions on Gaza predate the 2007 blockade by over a decade. Since the early 1990s, movement of people and goods has been progressively curtailed, with the Hamas takeover of Gaza serving as the basis for sealing the territory entirely by land, air, and sea. Items as basic as cement, irrigation pipes, and medical supplies have repeatedly been denied entry under a dual-use classification, where security justifications are applied broadly enough to cover goods with no plausible military application. The result has been a humanitarian shortfall that has persisted for close to twenty years. In the West Bank, settlement construction has continued without interruption since 1967, eating into Palestinian land and tightening movement restrictions across the territory. For humanitarian organizations, this shrinking of operational space has made neutral, impartial access increasingly difficult to sustain on the ground.

3.6 Case Studies-

A) "The war turned our lives upside down and took everything from us."

The explosion came without warning.

An UNRWA administrative officer in their fifties, someone who had spent a lifetime serving their community, remembers the sound splitting through the air over Khan Younis. Just half an hour earlier, a 27 year old son had walked out the door, heading to a nearby UNRWA school that had been converted into an emergency shelter. Just to use the internet. A simple, ordinary thing.

"I did not think the school would be hit. It was full of displaced people."

Forty people were killed that day in June 2024. A son who had dedicated his studies to special education and who loved helping people with disabilities was among them.

And yet, the next morning, this UNRWA worker returned to work. Not because the grief was gone. But because the people who needed help were still there. Through loss, through hunger, through a home nearly destroyed in the Rafah invasion of May 2024, through days when bread and flour simply could not be found, the work continued.

"We lost our home, everything inside it, electricity, water, education, access to clinics. Any sense of safety was gone."

"UNRWA has been part of my life since my birth. Work became a way to escape. But it was also a responsibility toward people who needed help."

This is not a story about survival alone. It is a story about what happens when a protected humanitarian space, a UN school sheltering displaced families, is bombed. It is a story about what International Humanitarian Law exists to prevent. And it is a story this committee must reckon with.

B) "I was happy and comfortable. I had a home. We had food and water."

These words are not spoken. They are signed.

A 40-year-old deaf Palestinian refugee, standing on uneven ground in front of an emergency tent somewhere in the Gaza Strip, hands moving through the air, translating a life that once was into words the world needs to hear. Before the war, there was already grief to carry. Her husband lost to COVID-19 in 2021. Three children to raise alone. And still stability. A job teaching at a school for persons with disabilities. A home. Food on the table. A life built carefully, quietly, against the odds.

Then October 2023 arrived and took all of it.

The home, gone. The school, gone. The livelihood, gone. A family that had already lost so much was displaced once more, this time into a tent on uneven ground, in a territory where humanitarian aid cannot get through, where the corridors that should carry safety have been sealed shut.

But the tent in front of which this refugee stands today is not just a shelter. It has become something else, a makeshift embroidery training space, where displaced

women and girls gather around tables covered with fabric, thread, and needles. A quiet, defiant act of rebuilding in the middle of rubble.

"I was happy and comfortable. I had a home. We had food and water."

Behind every blocked humanitarian corridor, behind every denied aid truck, behind every violated UN facility, there is a person who once had a home, who once had food and water, and who is now hoping someone on the other side of the world is finally listening.

unrwa
الأونروا

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

4. Other countries around the world

(Opinions of other countries on Palestine)

United States of America (USA)-

For over seven decades, the United States was not just a supporter of Palestinian refugees. Contributing between \$300 million and \$400 million to UNRWA every year, the US helped an entire humanitarian system, one that kept millions of Palestinian refugees fed, educated, and sheltered across Gaza, the West Bank, Jordan, Lebanon, and Syria.

Under the Biden administration, Israel accused a dozen UNRWA staff members of links to the October 7, 2023 attacks. Without waiting for verification, the US paused its funding in January 2024. Congress went further, formally suspending all American contributions to UNRWA even after an independent investigation concluded that Israeli authorities had not provided sufficient evidence to back their claims. The funding never came back.

When the Trump administration took office, restraint was abandoned entirely. On February 4, 2025, President Trump signed Executive Order 14199 permanently

cutting all US funding to UNRWA, citing alleged infiltration by members of designated foreign terrorist organizations. At the same time, the administration signed a 2026 defense budget allocating over \$4 billion in security support to Israel. The math was stark: \$4 billion to one side of the conflict, zero to the agency keeping the other side alive.

In January 2026, President Trump signed a Presidential Memorandum withdrawing the United States from 66 international organizations, including 31 UN entities. Plans were announced to exit UNESCO by December 2026. The withdrawal from the World Health Organization had already been signed on inauguration day. Funding to the International Criminal Court, the International Court of Justice, and the UN Human Rights Council's Commission of Inquiry on Israel was blocked. One by one, the institutions mandated to hold the world accountable under International Humanitarian Law lost the participation of their most powerful member.

At the UN Security Council, the US representative, as author of Resolution 2803 (2025), described an American-backed plan as *"no mere paper promise, but a lifeline"*, proposing an International Stabilization Force to secure Gaza's streets, oversee demilitarization, protect civilians, and escort aid through safe corridors.

On October 13, 2025, President Trump stood alongside leaders from Egypt, Qatar, Turkey, and other nations at Sharm El-Sheikh, backing a peace framework built around a ceasefire, hostage releases, and Gaza's phased demilitarization under international oversight. A US General was appointed to lead the proposed Stabilization Force in January 2026. The force, however, has not yet been formed. Israel continues to oppose the participation of Turkey and Qatar. The corridors remain closed.

The United States writes Security Council resolutions demanding the protection of humanitarian corridors with one hand and, with the other, defunds the only agency capable of operating those corridors at scale. Every other country that initially suspended UNRWA funding alongside the US, the United Kingdom, the European Union, Canada, France, Germany, Japan, and Australia has since resumed its

contributions. The United States alone has not.

France-

For decades, France chose its words carefully. It believed in a two-state solution, it voted in favor of Palestinian rights at the United Nations, it condemned violations of international law, but it never took the final step.

Then, on September 22, 2025,

Standing before the United Nations General Assembly, President Emmanuel Macron said that recognizing Palestine was a way of affirming that the Palestinian people are not people too many. The United Kingdom, Canada, and several other Western allies moved in the same direction, a coordinated wave of recognition that the world had been waiting years to see.

Four out of the five permanent members of the UN Security Council, France, the United Kingdom, Russia, and China now stand on the same side of this question.

At the UN Security Council, France's representative stood up and demanded that Israel lift every obstacle blocking humanitarian assistance into Gaza, not some obstacles, not most, but all of them

and that every humanitarian actor, every UN agency, every international NGO be allowed to continue their work without restriction.

On January 28, 2026, France issued an official statement that left nothing to interpretation. It demanded the expanded, safe, and unimpeded delivery of aid throughout Gaza and the West Bank. It demanded the reopening of all crossing points, including Rafah. It demanded the lifting of restrictions on humanitarian goods, including those arbitrarily classified as having dual use. And it demanded full Israeli compliance with international law.

Israeli legislation adopted in October 2024 and quietly strengthened in December 2025 forbade contact between Israeli officials and UNRWA, prohibited UNRWA's presence in East Jerusalem, and cut off electricity, water, and gas to UNRWA properties.

France is a permanent Security Council member, a historic ally of Israel, a formal recognizer of Palestinian statehood, a consistent funder of UNRWA, and a country that has deployed its own personnel to help keep humanitarian corridors open.

South Africa-

South Africa holds the most assertive pro-Palestinian position in the international system, rooted in its own apartheid history. This comparison links Israel's actions toward Palestinians straight to apartheid in South Africa - an ideological stance, far beyond mere politics. Full recognition of Palestine stands clear here. Since October 2023, their envoy has been pulled from Israel. The fight by Palestinians is seen through the lens of resisting settler rule.

South Africa brought charges **against Israel at the International Court of Justice in late 2023, invoking the Genocide Convention - marking** the strongest legal move by any country so far. The claim rests on mass civilian deaths, deliberate obstruction of food and medical supplies, along with weaponized hunger during combat. When peace took hold in 2025, Pretoria made clear: the lawsuit wouldn't stop.

Israel-

Under the governance of Netanyahu, the state of Israel opposes Palestinian statehood and instead prefers the status quo, where Israel maintains overall control and Palestinians live under a fundamentally

unequal rights framework. Israeli officials have openly threatened to annex the West Bank in direct response to the growing wave of international recognition of Palestinian statehood, a move that the Israeli parliament already called for in a non-binding resolution adopted in July 2025. Israel has boycotted the July 2025 UN Two-State Solution Conference alongside the United States which aimed to:

- a. Develop a widely supported international framework for ending the Gaza war
- b. Address disarmament of Hamas and release of hostages
- c. Reform the Palestinian Authority
- d. Chart a concrete path toward a two-state solution

The Israeli government has sought expansion of its settlement policy, established post the 1967 war, and has used it as a measure to establish Israeli dominance. Constituting Israeli civilian communities built on land captured during the 1967 Six-Day War in the West Bank and East Jerusalem, the settlement policy, although considered illegal under international law by the UN and the ICJ, has seen a rapid expansion following the implementation of the below mentioned measures:

- a. The Israeli cabinet (on 11 December 2025) approved the legalization and establishment of 19 new settler outposts in the West Bank.
- b. The Israeli government justified it as a "framework intended to block the establishment of a Palestinian state and continuation of Israel's sovereign right to settle in the land."
- c. Despite widespread condemnation from countries such as Canada, Japan etc., Israel's foreign minister rejected such claims, asserting the Jewish people's right to a national homeland across the entire territory of Mandatory Palestine

The Israeli government has also been accused of coordinating settler attacks on Palestinian communities. Referring to acts of violence carried out by Israeli settlers (civilians living in Israeli settlements built in the occupied West Bank) against Palestinian communities, their land, and their property, such settler violence is recorded at a frequency of 8–10 per day, despite the deployment of soldiers nearby attack scenes.

- Legislation was passed in October 2024 that prohibited UNRWA operations in areas Israel considers sovereign territory.

- Laws passed in December 2025 cut utilities to UNRWA facilities and authorized the expropriation of UN properties.
- Israel blocked all international UNRWA staff visas, alongside preventing UNRWA humanitarian aid from Gaza since March 2025

Apart from this, Israel has maintained a land, air, and sea blockade of Gaza since 2007, citing security concerns and the apparent need to prevent weapon smuggling into Hamas-controlled territory. Yet sources accuse such actions of violating the basic tenets laid down by Article 33 of the Fourth Geneva Convention.

According to the UN Commission of Inquiry, the Israeli forces have conducted extensive demolition and expansion of buffer zones and corridors, reaching some 75 per cent of the Gaza Strip till July 2025, amounting to deliberate deprivation of indispensable resources.

However, Israel established the Gaza Humanitarian Foundation (GHF) in May 2025 as an alternative to UN-led aid distribution. Argued by various Israeli officials, the set-up of the GHF was a “crucial” step, especially since such officials believed UNRWA's distribution infrastructure had been compromised by

Hamas. The UN has, however, argued that the institution of GHF was a militarized system that bypassed humanitarian principles and endangered civilians seeking food.

- On 21 January 2025, Israeli forces launched Operation Iron Wall that had been a major militarized operation in the northern West Bank which resulted in the longest and most extensive displacement crisis since 1967, forcibly displacing up to 40,000 persons.

Syria-

Syria and Israel have historically shared ties marked by uncertainty and instability. Since the ‘Six-Day War’ of 1967, Israel has illegally occupied the region of Golan Heights arbitrarily. Naturally, therefore, the Syrian Republic has supported the idea of the creation of a separate Palestinian state. This idea was also supported by the former ruler of the country, Bashar al-Assad (during an Arab League summit in 2023), whose dictatorial rule saw mass destruction of lives under the Syrian Civil War, which lasted for 13 years. During this period, however, his own forces besieged and bombed Palestinians who sought refuge in Syria.

While the Syrian government has historically projected itself as supportive of the Palestinian cause, during the course of the civil war, Syrian government forces deliberately targeted Palestinian civilians in the Yarmouk district. On the other hand, Hamas is also believed to have supported anti-government opinions during the course of the civil war, which stirred resentment between the two. While these hostilities between the two ended in 2023, Syria has expressed its opinions through strident rhetoric, but limited action.

Yemen-

Yemen's involvement with this agenda is based on both its participation as a signatory to the international humanitarian framework and its experience with regard to the Yemen Civil War. Yemen is a signatory to the Geneva Conventions and their Additional Protocols, which outline the legal obligations of states to protect civilians and allow for the provision of humanitarian assistance to civilians in times of armed conflict. Yemen has also voted on

multiple resolutions in the United Nations General Assembly, including A/RES/77/27, that have renewed the mandate for UNRWA's operations in Palestine.

The ongoing Yemen conflict is a critical, practical case study for this agenda. Since 2014, Yemen has been involved in civil war, and its territory has been divided, with parts of its land being controlled by the Houthis, the internationally recognized Yemen government, and various other armed non-state actors. As a result of the conflicting factions, humanitarian access to the civilian population is often blocked. Access to humanitarian aid to Yemen's population is heavily reliant on strategic ports and infrastructure, with the Port of Al-Hudaydah being one of the most important assets for delivery of humanitarian assistance to the people of Yemen, as disruptions to the Port due to military conflict directly affect the ability of the civilian population to obtain food, medicine, and other much needed supplies.

5. Other countries around the world

a) China-

Under the rule of the Communist Party of China, the Chinese state has been one of the most vocal supporters of Palestinian Statehood. China has argued that the Israeli-Palestinian conflict deepens primarily because the two-state solution is only half achieved, i.e. while the State of Israel remains in existence, the State of Palestine, however remains far beyond reach. Officials of the Chinese government stress that only after the establishment of an independent State of Palestine and the realization of the legitimate rights of the Palestinian nation can historical injustices and the root causes of violence be eliminated.

Under the Chinese Ministry of Foreign Affairs,

- a. The country has explicitly reinforced the equality of rights between Israel and Palestine regarding establishment of a state. They have reiterated that “the lives of the Israeli people and the Arab people are equally precious, and neither should be deemed superior to the other.”

- b. The government has actively voiced criticism of Israeli Actions, stating that Israel's insistence on advancing its plan to take over Gaza City and its acceleration of encroachment on West Bank territory seriously violates the norms of international law.

China has thus developed "Three Imperatives" for resolving the conflict. These include:

- a. It is imperative to promote a comprehensive ceasefire in Gaza with the greatest sense of urgency to alleviate the current humanitarian disaster.
- b. It is imperative to truly implement the principle of "Palestinians governing Palestine", and Gaza and the West Bank are both inalienable territories of Palestine. Any post-war governance and reconstruction arrangements should respect the will of the Palestinian people.
- c. It is imperative to firmly uphold the two-state solution, pool greater international consensus, and reject any unilateral actions that erode the

foundation of the two-state solution.

One of the major policy reformations introduced by the Chinese government, in response to the ongoing conflict in the Near East, was “The Beijing Declaration”:

- Initiated in July 2024, China invited all Palestinian factions to Beijing for reconciliation
- The Declaration aimed to achieve:
 - Commitment towards the establishment of an independent State of Palestine with Jerusalem as the capital city based on relevant UN resolutions and ensuring the integrity of Palestinian territory, including the West Bank, Jerusalem and Gaza.
 - The parties agreed to establish an interim national reconciliation government, carry out reconstruction in Gaza, and prepare and hold a general election as soon as possible.

Apart from the Beijing Declaration, the Chinese government further proposed a 3-step plan including:

1. Achieve Palestinian internal reconciliation and unity
2. Establish post-conflict governance of Gaza under "Palestinians governing Palestine"
3. Help Palestine become a full member state of the UN and implement the two-state solution.

Further, China has used its permanent member status to favor Palestinian interests and positions. These include:

1. Voted in favor of ceasefire resolutions
2. Criticized US vetoes of ceasefire resolutions as enabling Israeli operations
3. China contributed to the UN Security Council's adoption of the first ceasefire-related resolution since the outbreak of the conflict and released a Position Paper on Resolving the Palestinian-Israeli Conflict. The Washington Institute
4. Participated in ICJ advisory opinion proceedings on Palestinian self-determination

Yet despite this critical analysis by an Israeli think tank (INSS), which argued that by hosting organizations such as Hamas in its capital and legitimizing them, “China

placed itself on the side that supports terrorism”. Further, China's practical support for Palestinians has been quite minimal in financial terms, and Beijing's primary interest had been to present itself as a responsible global power and effective mediator instead of achieving genuine Palestinian reconciliation.

b) Russia-

During the Soviet era, the Kremlin showed hostility and severed its ties with Israel. Based on its suspicion of Soviet Jews and their divided loyalties following the creation of Israel in 1948, the USSR actively prevented Soviet Jews from leaving the country and built up strong relationships with the Palestinian Liberation Organization and Arab countries that were collectively opposed to Israel. However, following the fall of the Soviet rule and the creation of Russia, the Kremlin improved its relations with Israel, while simultaneously maintaining its historic ties to Palestine. This balancing act became known as Russia's "equidistance" policy. Yet, the outbreak of the post-October 7 war led Russia to take a clearly pro-Palestinian stance and harshly criticize Israel's military response.

Russia has supported the creation of a Palestinian state within the 1967 borders,

with East Jerusalem as its capital. Capable of coexisting with Israel in peace and security, such an independent Palestinian state has been constantly put forth by Russia. It has collectively voiced opposition to proposed “US Control” of Gaza, including criticism of any plans aimed at displacing Palestinians from their homeland, such as Trump's proposal to transform Gaza into a so-called “Middle East Riviera.” Russia also firmly believes that the establishment of an American administration in Gaza would compromise the land's autonomy, and instead asserts that neither the United States nor any foreign entity has the right to govern Gaza.

Russia has used its permanent member veto power continuously in ways that favor Palestinian positions:

1. Voted in favor of ceasefire resolutions in Gaza
2. When the UN Security Council convened to discuss British-US proposals on Gaza, Russia used its veto power (a position Palestinians have appreciated). However, Russia's own motions for a ceasefire in Gaza at the UNSC in October were voted down by the US, UK, France, and Japan.

3. Voted alongside China against the July 2025 New York Declaration's endorsement

Russia has diplomatic relations with the political wing of Hamas and has never designated Hamas as a terrorist organization. Yet it has condemned Hamas attacks as terrorism.

After the October 7 attacks, Russia condemned the attack as terrorism and Putin sent condolences to Israeli families, saying Israel had a right to defend itself. He simultaneously condemned the subsequent Israeli bombardments of Gaza and called for a two-state solution.

Russia has sent over 800 tonnes of cargo to those in need in Gaza, including food, medicine, and essential items, describing itself as doing its best as a friend of the Palestinian people to provide regular aid.

c) Iran-

Before the 1979 uprising in Iran, the PLO worked closely with dissenting factions inside the country. Under the rule of the Shah, Iran became the first major Muslim state after Turkey to quietly acknowledge Israel's existence. Once the political shift happened, everything changed. The new leadership cut links with Israel without delay. Support then shifted toward

Palestinian causes instead. A strong signal came when Tehran handed the Israeli diplomatic office over to the PLO. From the start, Iran's view on Israel ties back to Ayatollah Khomeini's beliefs - he saw the country as an extension of Western power, something that weakened Muslim solidarity. Ever since 1979, this idea has shaped how Iran acts abroad.

Iran rejects the two-state solution outright, stating: "The only real and lasting solution is the establishment of a single democratic state through a referendum with the participation of all Palestinians, inside and outside the occupied territories." Iran has formally disassociated itself from any reference to East Jerusalem, the 1967 borders, and related concepts.

From the top down, Iran's stance toward Israel flows through key institutions anchored by the Supreme Leader's office and the IRGC. Across regions, actions unfold less through official armies, instead relying on partnerships with organized forces outside state control. Hezbollah operates in Lebanon under this arrangement, while similar patterns appear with the Houthis in Yemen. In Palestinian areas, groups like Hamas and Palestinian Islamic Jihad take part in the broader structure. These connections form a web of

coordination shaped by Tehran's strategic direction but executed at arm's length.

According to Palestinian Authority President Mahmoud Abbas, Hamas is funded by Iran. Iran also supplies Hamas with military weaponry, including Fajr-5, M-75, and M-302 rockets, as well as drones. Aid to Hamas increased after Israel's withdrawal from Gaza in 2005.

Iran's Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei strongly refuted claims of direct involvement on October 7. Iran's relationship with Palestinians is not monolithic; rather, it supports Hamas but has a deeply troubled relationship with the Palestinian Authority.

The Fatah party released a statement in April 2024 opposing Iranian involvement in Palestinian affairs, asserting that external interference by Iran has no other objective than to sow chaos in the Palestinian

internal arena, which will only benefit the Israeli occupation and the enemies of the Palestinian people.

When the Israeli government and the PLO agreed in 1993 on the Oslo Accords' two-state solution framework, Iran opposed it. Iran severed diplomatic relations with Egypt in 1979 due to its signing of the Camp David Accords with Israel. This means Iran has actively opposed

every diplomatic agreement that could have advanced Palestinian statehood through negotiation, a position that puts it at odds with the PA, Jordan, Egypt, Saudi Arabia, and the broader .

d) United Kingdom-

The British policy on Palestine is not a tale of reasonableness; it is a tale of inconsistency. The UK sided with Israel in the Gaza war, gave Israel information on surveillance of Gaza, and even sold arms to the Israeli military, but at the same time, criticized the assassination of Palestinian civilians and the blockading of the Gaza Strip. Two governments, one Conservative and the other one being Labour, have both requested a ceasefire and a two-states solution. They both have failed to overcome the basic tension that lies at the center of British policy.

In 2023, Palestine, the UK pledged more than £100 million of aid to Palestine, then £35 million to UNRWA and £129 million to Palestine the following year, and £34 million to UNRWA. But, similar to others, the UK decided not to give future funding to the organisation in January 2024 after Israeli claims against UNRWA employees, despite an independent review saying that no credible evidence was being produced to

support the claims. The UK would later solve its contributors.

The UK assisted in the provision of a humanitarian land route between Jordan and Gaza with 750 tonnes of life-saving food relief delivered in the initial delivery and the appointment of a Foreign Secretary Representative of Humanitarian Affairs to the Occupied Palestinian Territories. But the UK parliament itself recognized the embarrassing fact that the diplomatic efforts of the UK and other donors to make accessibility and save lives have so far failed. In December 2025, the UK joined nine other foreign ministers in a joint statement which demanded that Israel provide unimpeded humanitarian access in all of Gaza, that it name UNRWA as a critical healthcare and education provider to millions of Palestinian refugees and that it open Rafah and impose restrictions on dual-use items.

In September 2024, the UK suspended approximately 30 out of 350 of its exports-to-Israel arms licences, its Foreign Secretary, David Lammy, having determined that there was a high risk that they could be used to commit or assist a grave contravention of international humanitarian law. But 320 licences were still in operation. In June 2025, the High

Court in Britain decided that the export of F-35 fighter jet components to Israel was legal. One Foreign Office officer of UNRWA had already resigned in protest.

The State of Palestine is officially recognised by the UK in September 2025, and the UK is joining France, Canada, and other allies in the West. In cases where Israel enacted laws to prohibit UNRWA, Prime Minister Starmer expressed his worry by saying: I am deeply worried, only UNRWA is capable of providing humanitarian aid in the number and rates required.

e) Egypt-

It borders only on the non-Israeli Gaza, which has turned out to be one of the most decisive geographical strips in the world. The Egyptian relation to the Palestinian cause is characterized by Cairo as unchangeable and rooted in national security and the geographical, historical, and human ties between Egypt and Palestine. Never has that relationship been more challenged than it is.

The center of Egypt's involvement in this crisis is the Rafah crossing, which is the sole entry point to Gaza, not under Israeli

controlled territories. Controlling the crossing, but importation at Rafah needs Israeli permission under a long-standing agreement between Egypt and Israel. That has turned the crossing into a lifeline and a choke point, one that Israel has opened and closed, one that it has bombed and occupied at will.

In May 2024, Israel occupied the Rafah Border Crossing during the Gaza war and would only leave afterwards in January 2025 as part of the ceasefire agreement. The reopening of the crossing has been partial and dangerous even after the ceasefire. By the time Rafah was open again, in February 2026, only about 50 Palestinians per day were permitted to walk in and out of Gaza on foot by Israel, with each individual being subject to prior Israeli security services clearance and EU inspection at the crossing point and passing through a second identity checkpoint within an Israel-controlled corridor.

Egypt has not stopped the aid anyway. As of February 23, 2026, the 144th outbound convoy of Egyptian humanitarian aid trucks had traversed Gaza via the Rafah crossing, carrying food parcels, flour, fresh bread, medicines, tents and petroleum products, all of which are checked by the

Israeli authorities at Kerem Shalom before being allowed into the strip.

The most significant and debatable stance of Egypt has been its absolute refusal to receive displaced Palestinians. President Abdel Fattah El-Sisi has been insistent on the issue of not accepting high populations of Palestinian refugees into Sinai, terming it a red line that, when crossed, would lead to the liquidation of the Palestinian cause. The fear in Cairo is not just logistical fear: it is also existential fear. Mass displacement would essentially mean the destruction of the Palestinian right to return home, and would change an episodic crisis into a stable demographic fact.

As Israel declared that the Rafah crossing would only be opened when the citizens of Gaza wanted to head to Egypt, the foreign ministers of Egypt, Indonesia, Jordan, Pakistan, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Turkey and the UAE came up with a joint statement regarding their firm concern and full rejection of any efforts to displace the Palestinian people from their land. Egypt not only signed that statement, but headed it.

The Egyptian position cannot be said to be devoid of tensions and contradictions. Egyptian government officials have also

openly grumbled about the occupation of Israeli borders, and they have vehemently protested when Israel declared that the Rafah crossing would remain closed until further notice. Simultaneously, Egypt has also been accused of its intermittent closures of Rafah, and the larger fact that as the Arab nearest neighbor it has failed to provide proximity protection to Palestinians.

f) India-

The relations between India and Palestine are as old as those between India and Israel. In the decades that followed independence, India had been one of the loudest proponents of Palestinian self-determination in the international system, both due to its own struggle against colonialism, its chairing of the Non-Aligned Movement and the straightforwardness of its first Prime Minister, Jawaharlal Nehru. India never even opened diplomatic relations with Israel until 1992.

The rapprochement between New Delhi and Tel Aviv, which started gaining momentum in the 1990s under Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has been given an intense push since 2014, with India currently operating as a potent ally of Israel

without actually stating it. The change has not been proclaimed. It has been made known, vote by vote, silence by silence, in the United Nations.

India voted against a UN General Assembly resolution on October 27, 2023, to declare a humanitarian truce in Gaza, which was adopted by 120 states. The Minister of External Affairs, Jaishankar, said that India could not go by a resolution which failed to directly condemn the Hamas attack. India subsequently voted in support of the resolutions of ceasefire in December 2023 and December 2024, indicating its strategy was not predetermined. But then came June 12, 2025.

India defied a UN General Assembly resolution on June 12, 2025, declaring an urgent, unconditional and permanent ceasefire in Gaza, a declaration that expressly criticized the practice of starvation and denial of aid as war tactics, and insisted that Israel remove the blockade on Gaza and open all the border points to aid delivery. 149 countries voted in favour. The United States and Israel were the only two that voted against. Among 19 countries, India was one of the countries which abstained.

Since the start of the dilemma, India has given about 135 metric tonnes of

humanitarian assistance to Palestinians, and 81.5 metric tonnes of medicines and medical goods were distributed in four batches. India has additionally disbursed a total of 12.5 million dollars and 2.5 million dollars in November of 2025 to UNRWA.

When the Prime Minister of India, Modi, visited Israel, India and Israel raised their relations to a special strategic partnership. In November 2025, it agreed, in a memorandum of understanding, to develop and produce military equipment together and focus on advanced technology transfer. The two parties also decided to enable the hiring of more than 50,000 Indian employees in Israel within the next five years.

Israeli Finance Minister Bezalel Smotrich, a far-right politician who had earlier said that it was justified and moral to starve the civilian population of Gaza, visited India in September 2025 and signed a trade and investment agreement with the Indian Finance Minister on cybersecurity and defence. It was not questioned publicly on his stand on Gaza.

When Israel violated the January 2025 ceasefire and carried out raids that killed 424 civilians, including 174 children the Prime Minister and Ministry of External Affairs of India said nothing publicly, and

the MEA was on the record advertising a separate home event.

g) Pakistan-

Pakistan has had a consistent stand since the very establishment of the state in 1947; one that does not change along with the election periods, does not melt at the convenience of diplomacy and does not need inference between the lines. Pakistan has never accepted Israel and does not have any diplomatic ties with it.

The Pakistani has not only been talking but also acting. Pakistan has since shipped several consignments of humanitarian aid to Gaza and is working on more deliveries that have totalled 1,615 tonnes of relief materials, including food, ready-made meals, powdered milk, medicines, and medical equipment, coordinated by the National Disaster Management Authority in Pakistan to deliver the relief materials to the needy as quickly as possible.

The Pakistani government pressured the nations that halted their funding to UNRWA to rethink as soon as possible, making it clear that the very lives of the people in Gaza are at stake and that they need this essential aid. In a move to restore and strengthen international assistance to UNRWA, Pakistan requested the same at

the OIC Council of Foreign Ministers, terming it as an essential part and parcel of the survival of the millions of Palestinians.

The crisis reaction framework of seven points proposed by Pakistan at the OIC directly relates to the agenda of this committee: an immediate, permanent and unconditional ceasefire; unhindered, lasting and safe humanitarian access among all the civilians; protection of aid workers, medical workers and the UN workers; renewed international support to UNRWA; forced displacement to be stopped; accountability of war crimes; and achievement of Palestinian self-determination by own state on the borders of 1967 with Al-Quds Al-Sharif as its capital.

h) Qatar-

Qatar is a nation of less than three million resting on a belt of desert peninsula in the Arabian Gulf. It does not have an army that can project force in the region. It does not have a historic colonial presence in Palestine. However, upon the announcement of the January 2025 ceasefire between Israel and Hamas to the international community, the Prime Minister of Qatar was the one who was at the podium at Doha when the announcement was made.

The power was determined by decades of calculated, patient, and sometimes most controversial positioning in a small state that its strength would not lie in militant armament but rather in its ability to be needed by all at the same time. That has positioned Qatar as the most significant diplomatic participant in the room in the Gaza crisis.

A ceasefire deal involving Qatar, the United States and Egypt suspended the Gaza war on 19 January 2025, where Israeli hostages and Palestinian prisoners were released. Another Gaza peace accord that was mediated by Qatar, the United States, Turkey and Egypt took effect on 10 October 2025.

In October 2025, the release of 33 Israeli captives and five Thai nationals was made in exchange for releasing 1,755 Palestinian detainees. Qatar never gave up between the two contracts. The Foreign Minister of Qatar, along with those of Egypt, highlighted the immediate need to restart the ceasefire, cessation of bloodshed of the Palestinian people, release of hostages and detainees, and the urgency and unhindered delivery of humanitarian assistance to the Gaza Strip on July 1, 2025.

In 2025-2026, in the occupied Palestinian territory, Syria, Lebanon, and Jordan, the

Qatar Fund for Development signed a core contribution agreement of \$20 million to facilitate the work of UNRWA with a particular focus on the humanitarian work of the organization in the Gaza Strip, primary care, and education of Palestinian refugees.

Qatar has contributed to the extent of 49 million dollars to the UNRWA, and the Qatar Fund of Development Director General made it clear that the contribution was to show that Qatar had no wavering commitment to support the Palestinian people in the face of the worst humanitarian crisis of our age.

Qatar was the first Arab state to make a multi-year agreement with UNRWA, which it signed in December 2018, years prior to the current crisis that made this support politically noticeable.

In addition to the institutional financing, Qatar has directly donated to Gaza. The ceasefire, which took effect in January 2025, saw 107 fuel trucks supplied by Qatar cross the Kerem Abu Salem border crossing carrying 5 million litres of fuel to the Gaza Strip to run hospitals, generators of power, and vital infrastructure that had a target of 12 million litres. Qatar also sent 90 aid trucks containing 100,000 food parcels, amounting to 1,670 tonnes of food, that

were distributed in Gaza by crossing the borders of Jordan.

On a personal encounter with the United States Secretary of State, Marco Rubio in Washington, the Prime Minister of Qatar highlighted that the violation of the ceasefire egos by Israel was threatening to bring down the whole agreement, as delays and ceasefire violations are dangerous to the whole process and put mediators in a tricky situation.

i) Kuwait-

Kuwait never talks of Palestine in geopolitical calculations. It describes it using the words of duty, ethical, history, and humanitarian. Kuwait is one of the most stable Arab advocates of the Palestinian cause. Since the establishment of UNRWA in 1949, it has provided not only financial support but also political, diplomatic, and vocal support in all multilateral forums where the Palestinian cause has been on the agenda. Kuwait is not in an area where there is a change in positions depending on the political wind.

Kuwait Foreign Affairs Minister reiterated the Kuwaiti support to the Palestinian people, including its assistance to UNRWA, and that the Agency is a fundamental pillar of humanitarian endeavor and emphasizing

the significance of its good humanitarian services to the Palestinian refugees.

Kuwait urged the regional partners of UNRWA to contribute to the sustenance of the necessary services in Gaza, the West Bank, Jordan, Lebanon and Syria in the realization that when the Western donors withdraw, the pressure is exerted.

At the UN General Assembly, a representative of Kuwait, who was representing the Arab Group emphasized that the existing Israeli blocks and restrictions of aid are an outrageous act against the responsibilities of the occupying state and only worsen the great humanitarian situation in Gaza.

They represent a legal claim in itself that states what is occurring in Gaza to be a breach of the duty of an occupying force against the provisions of the international humanitarian law.

In March 2025, on the chair of the GCC Ministerial Council, the Foreign Minister of Kuwait chaired a statement that denounced the decision on 2 March 2025 of the Israeli occupation government to prohibit the entry of humanitarian aid into Gaza as a severe breach of the ceasefire agreement, of the international law of humanitarian and of the Fourth Geneva

Convention of 8 October 1967 urging the international community to cease these egregious breaches by the Israeli occupation government, of the international humanitarian law and of the Fourth Geneva Convention.

It was also during this session that the Israeli occupation forces were condemned over the attacks on humanitarian and other United Nations bodies in Gaza, as well as assaults on humanitarian aid convoys by Israeli settlers, which highlighted the need for the Israeli forces under the international humanitarian law to protect such convoys, deliver aid, and not hinder the work of the international organizations.

The GCC Ministerial Council, which was assembled under Kuwait, declared that it opposed any attempts to displace the population of Gaza as gross breaches of international law and international humanitarian law, and demanded the international protection of the Palestinian population emphasizing that the future of Gaza should have a unified Palestinian state and implementation of the two-state solution.

j) Oman-

Oman has, over the decades, developed one of the most unique foreign policy identities

in the world. It facilitated backdoor negotiations between the US and Iran. It was used in exchange for prisoners. It maintained lines of communication as everybody else had banged their doors. Oman was not a talkative country. That was the point.

On 15 February 2024, Oman Foreign Minister Sayyid Badr Albusaid called unexpectedly for action and said that events had overtaken him and that the time had come to convene an emergency international conference with a brief to agree arrangements on Palestinian statehood and to establish mechanisms to bring them into action, indicating that Hamas would have to be included in the conference.

In response to a US veto at the Security Council on 9 December 2023, Sayyid Badr said: The veto at the Security Council is a disgrace to humanitarian standards. It really breaks my heart that the United States must give up the lives of innocent civilians in the name of Zionism. The world will take a backward glance at today and be ashamed of it long after we are gone.

And in November 2025, the Foreign Minister Albusaid went even further, when he publicly said that it has long been known that it is not Iran that is the greatest

source of insecurity in the region, but Israel. These are not diplomatic words, given that these were active sales of US arms with the Gulf states, amounting to \$2.72 billion. They are a declaration.

Sultan Haitham and King Abdullah II urged the UN Security Council to pass a resolution to impose an immediate ceasefire, safeguard civilians, and deliver humanitarian aid by all available means, rejecting any efforts to separate Gaza and the West Bank, and threatening Israeli escalation and attacks on Palestinians and humanitarian aid convoys.

The history of Palestine is impregnated in the voice of Oman that many nations are unable to possess. Through the Oslo Accords, there was the establishment of the Oman-based Middle East Desalination Research Center, which is a prototype of Arab-Israeli capacity building and joint research. Between Oslo and Oman, commercial offices have been established in the country of the other, but the Omani government shut them down in 2000 as a result of the Israeli violence against Palestinians during the second Intifada.

Oman was silent in their official response to the attacks by Hamas on October 7, and the Oman Permanent Representative to the Arab League termed the Palestinian attack

as a way of retaliation against the decades of Israeli occupation and that the Israeli efforts of displacing Gazans area prelude to genocide.

k) Saudi Arabia-

Saudi Arabia has maintained its role as a major financial and political backer of the Palestinian cause throughout its history while supporting the creation of an independent Palestinian state. The country supports the **two-state solution**, which requires the establishment of a Palestinian state that will use the **1967 borders** with East Jerusalem as its capital for international recognition.

The kingdom has denounced all acts of violence which target civilians in conflict regions while stating that it is essential to **safeguard humanitarian missions and provide aid groups with unrestricted movement**. The kingdom has established safe humanitarian corridors which operate throughout **Gaza and other affected regions** to enable aid groups to deliver essential food and medical supplies as well as shelter for civilians and refugees.

Saudi Arabia **utilizes regional diplomatic efforts and international organizations to endorse International Humanitarian Law (IHL)** compliance while emphasizing

the need to safeguard civilian populations and humanitarian personnel, as well as UN entities, which include UNRWA that provides essential services to Palestinians who have fled their homes.

Saudi Arabia **has provided extensive financial support for Palestinian humanitarian relief initiatives**. The country maintains its position that violence should decrease, while humanitarian corridors need protection, and the international community should enhance its efforts to assist Palestinian refugees who reside in the Near East.

l) UAE-

The United Arab Emirates supports a **two-state solution** to the Israeli-Palestinian conflict. The United Arab Emirates United Arab Emirates demands the creation of a Palestinian state, which will use the **1967 borders with East Jerusalem as its capital**. The United Arab Emirates United Arab Emirates demands that all parties in combat zones must protect civilians while providing humanitarian aid in Gaza.

The United Arab Emirates has demanded **humanitarian pauses, together with**

safe humanitarian corridors which will deliver essential aid items, including food and medical supplies and shelter to all civilian populations who need assistance, including Palestinian refugees. The country emphasizes that all parties involved in armed conflicts must **observe International Humanitarian Law while they protect humanitarian workers and facilities.**

The United Arab Emirates has donated extensive humanitarian support, together with financial assistance, to relief operations which help Palestinians. The United Arab Emirates maintains its **demands for reduced conflict and greater humanitarian access and international collaboration** to assist civilians who suffer from the ongoing fighting.

m) Jordan-

Jordan functions as a central regional power in the Israeli-Palestinian dispute while supporting the creation of a Palestinian state, which would use the **1967 borders and East Jerusalem as its capital.** The Palestinian refugee problem occupies a central position for Jordan, which contains one of the biggest Palestinian refugee populations in the **Middle East.**

Jordan repeatedly demands both protection for civilians and the provision of humanitarian aid through operational channels in areas of military conflict, especially in Gaza. **The country has emphasized the urgent need for secure humanitarian corridors to ensure the safe delivery of aid,** which includes food and medical supplies and emergency relief to affected populations.

Jordan emphasizes the necessity to maintain International Humanitarian Law (IHL) standards while safeguarding humanitarian organizations that function in areas of military conflict, which involves United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA) services. **The government maintains its position that international partners should work together to decrease military conflicts while increasing humanitarian assistance for Palestinian refugees who live throughout the Near East.**

n) Lebanon-

Lebanon has historically supported the Palestinian cause and advocated for the establishment of an independent Palestinian state based on the **1967**

borders with East Jerusalem as its capital. The political position of Lebanon is determined by the large number of Palestinian refugees who reside in the nation, especially in its permanent refugee settlements.

The Lebanese government requires international organizations to take responsibility for Palestinian refugee needs because the country faces economic difficulties and political problems, which make it difficult to administer these requirements. **The government establishes requirements for secure humanitarian access to areas experiencing conflict because of its need to protect civilian populations**

from ongoing violent conflicts, which require assistance.

Lebanon upholds International Humanitarian Law (IHL) standards while safeguarding humanitarian organizations that operate in refugee camps and conflict zones, especially those who provide services through the United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA). The country continues to advocate for increased international support which protects civilian populations while it seeks permanent solutions to the Palestinian refugee crisis in the Near East.

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

6. Vulnerable Groups

a) Children-

As of mid-2025, more than 19,000 children have been reported killed in Gaza, with over 42,000 injured. All 320,000 children under the age of five are at risk of acute malnutrition. Over 97% of schools have been damaged or destroyed, thus leaving approximately 660,000 school-age children without access to formal education for over two years. The psychological toll is to an extent that studies conducted before the escalation documented that over 53% of Gazan children already met PTSD diagnostic criteria, and current estimates suggest more than 80% now exhibit severe trauma symptoms.

“Save the Children”, said the occupied Palestinian territory, now ranks as the most dangerous place in the world for children. Of the child deaths identified, nearly 30 per cent were under the age of five, including 710 babies less than a year old, with 20 per cent of those infants born and killed during the war itself.

“Save the Children” estimated that some 21,000 additional children were missing by mid-2024, many believed to be buried

under rubble. About 20,000 children had been orphaned, abandoned, or separated from their parents within the first year of the conflict.

Education Indicator	Status (mid-2025)
Total school buildings in Gaza	564
Schools damaged or destroyed	97% (547 of 564)
Schools directly hit by strikes	432 (76.6%)
Schools needing full reconstruction or major rehabilitation	91.8% (518 of 564)
Children out of school	~660,000

As of September 2025, over 42,000 children had been injured. The World Health Organization estimates that about a quarter of all the injured, around 22,500 people, require acute and ongoing rehabilitation, including extremity injuries, amputations and head and spinal cord injuries, as well as burns.

In the West Bank alone, over 1,200 Palestinian children have been wounded since October 2023, with almost half of those injuries caused by live ammunition. More than 210 children have also been killed in the West Bank during that time. At various times during the conflict, only 17 of 36 hospitals in Gaza remained at least partially functional. The Israeli siege has also barred the entry of life-saving medications, with major obstacles opening up only this week to supply essential goods such as insulin pens, according to the WHO.

The term “scholasticide”, the methodical extermination of a people’s education system, has been used by UNRWA’s commissioner-general Philippe Lazzarini to characterize what took place in Gaza. As of before the outbreak of hostilities, the literacy rate in Gaza stood at close to 97 percent and its secondary school enrolment rate was about 90 per cent, with higher education enrollment hovering around 45

per cent. Primary and secondary education was free through government and UNRWA schools. This entire system is now dismantled.

UNRWA also reports that children are at heightened risk of exploitation, including child labour, early marriage, and recruitment by armed groups when out of school. UNICEF and partners have also reported rising cases of sexual exploitation and abuse (SEA), with 5,169 children receiving direct protection case management services.

b) People with disabilities-

Indicator (Pre-October 2023)	Gaza Strip	All Palestine
Total persons with disabilities	~58,000	~92,710 (115,000 est.)
Disability prevalence rate	2.6%	2.1%
Adult disability rate (18+)	3.9%	3.0%

Children with disabilities (estimated)	~98,000 (UNICEF est.)	—
--	-----------------------	---

containing at least one disabled member. Since the escalation of hostilities, that number has grown by 35%, as over 41,800 people have acquired life-altering injuries they will carry for the rest of their lives.

The Physical Toll

More than 5,000 amputations have been performed, three-quarters of them involving lower limbs, frequently without adequate anaesthesia and under conditions so compromised that many will require corrective surgery in the future. Children account for a quarter of all life-changing injuries, prompting OCHA to designate Gaza as home to the largest cohort of child amputees in modern history.

A System That No Longer Exists

83% of persons with pre-existing disabilities have lost their assistive devices. As of mid-2025, approximately 4,370 amputees are still waiting for basic mobility aids. Prosthetic limbs, wheelchairs, and rehabilitation equipment are classified as dual-use items by Israeli authorities, restricting their entry into Gaza on grounds of potential military utility. That restriction predates October 2023 and has made the current crisis considerably worse.

Rehabilitation Service Indicator	Status
Decline in rehabilitation services	62% collapse (by Nov 2025)
Rehabilitation health workers killed	42+ (as of Sept 2024)
Total number of health workers killed	>1,700
Prosthetists available in all of Gaza	8–9

Disability and the Gaza Crisis: Scale, Impact, and Systemic Failures

Before October 2023, Gaza was already home to approximately 58,000 persons with disabilities, constituting 2.6% of the population, with one in five households

Every major rehabilitation facility in Gaza has been destroyed or rendered non-functional, including:

- The Sheikh Hamad Hospital
- UNRWA's Rehabilitation Centre for the Visually Impaired, which had served visually impaired children continuously since 1962

Rehabilitation services now exist in only three hospitals across the entire Strip, all overwhelmed and critically under-equipped.

Left Behind During Evacuation

When Israeli forces issued mass evacuation orders in October 2023, no accessible formats were provided. The consequences were as follows:

- Destroyed infrastructure and rubble made physical movement impossible for wheelchair users and persons with mobility impairments
- Families were forced into impossible decisions, whether to flee, leaving behind those who could not evacuate or remain with such members in order to support them
- Designated safe zones lacked accessibility features, basic services, and were subsequently subjected to attacks regardless.

Pre-Existing Vulnerabilities

The current crisis did not emerge from nothing. Before October 2023:

- 42.5% of disabled children aged 6 to 9 in Gaza had never attended school
- The illiteracy rate among disabled persons stood at 32% nationally, rising to 46% among disabled women
- The number of persons with disabilities in Gaza had already doubled between 2007 and 2017, driven by successive military operations and use of force during events such as the Great March of Return

The Psychological Dimension

Beyond physical harm, the psychological consequences are profound and lasting:

- Persons with disabilities frequently describe feeling like a burden to their families, a perception directly linked to depression, suicidal ideation, and loss of will to live
- Children with amputations experience severe anxiety over their inability to flee future attacks, fear

- of being left behind, and disruption to all developmental continuity
- Children with disabilities who have been orphaned face compounded vulnerability, as the additional support they require is now entirely absent

c) Women-

Women and girls constitute one of the most affected groups during armed conflicts, which particularly impact densely populated areas such as the Gaza Strip. The conflict causes a rise in civilian deaths, together with forced displacement, food shortages and health service denial, which makes women into a vital group that needs special humanitarian protection.

The current statistics show that female and child casualties account for 70 per cent of total fatalities which occurred in Gaza since October 2023. The data demonstrates how armed conflicts create an unequal effect which harms civilian populations.

According to humanitarian agencies, more than 1.9 million people have been displaced from Gaza, which represents approximately 85 per cent of the total population. This group includes nearly 1 million women and girls.

Women experience serious health threats and protection problems during times of war. In Gaza, approximately 180 women deliver their babies each day. About 15 per cent of all deliveries need immediate medical assistance, which occurs in situations where hospitals either lack essential materials or sustain damage because of ongoing fighting.

The collapse of medical facilities has raised dangers which pregnant women face together with their newborns because multiple hospitals and medical centers have shut down their operations. Pregnant women now give birth in dangerous and unregulated locations, which became their only option after multiple medical facilities went out of operation.

The casualty figures provide additional evidence which shows the crisis situation. The United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA) reports that more than 9000 Palestinian women have died in Gaza. The daily death toll includes approximately 63 women who died in Gaza. The majority of deceased women had children.

Women become the main financial providers for their families because of conflict-related violence, which results in their family members dying. The death of

family members who used to support their families makes women into primary economic providers who face greater challenges in their caregiving responsibilities. Displacement increases the probability that people will experience gender-based violence.

d) Health-

Active combat zones create severe restrictions on healthcare access, which makes health services impossible to deliver during humanitarian crises that affect the Gaza Strip. Ongoing military fighting has destroyed healthcare facilities, forcing healthcare services to operate beyond their limits, preventing patients from receiving necessary medical treatments.

The reports show that more than 50% of Gaza hospitals have become fully nonoperational or only partially functional because of damage, fuel shortages, and missing essential medical resources. This has resulted in decreased ability to provide medical care for wounded civilians who require treatment and for patients with ongoing health needs. The healthcare system needs medicines, surgical tools, and skilled workers to address its urgent crisis, which currently faces severe equipment and staff shortages.

The World Health Organization has reported that tens of thousands of people have been injured, which creates excessive pressure on existing healthcare facilities that already operate at their limits. The blockade and ongoing conflict have created obstacles which prevent humanitarian aid from reaching its target locations and render delivery of medical supplies and hospital operation fuel impossible.

Public health risks are also rising rapidly. Overcrowded shelters and displacement affecting over 1.9 million people have increased the spread of infectious diseases, respiratory illnesses, and waterborne diseases due to poor sanitation and limited access to clean water.

The humanitarian organizations which include the United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA) and the World Health Organization have declared that immediate humanitarian corridors need creation and protection to enable safe medical delivery, wounded person evacuation and healthcare facility maintenance activities to proceed without disruption.

The protection of healthcare systems and medical personnel and civilian populations in conflict areas depends on maintaining

unrestricted humanitarian access which
International Humanitarian Law (IHL)
requires to be maintained without any bias.



unrwa
الأونروا

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

7. Past UN Actions

Most actions undertaken by the constituent bodies of the United Nations encompass the proliferation of various resolutions aimed at restricting Israeli occupation of Palestinian areas. Most significant of which are:

1. **1947, Res. 181:** Recommendation for partition of Palestine: This led to widespread resentment amongst the Arabs and Jews of the region and led to the subsequent 1948 war. It proposed that Jerusalem be made an international territory.
2. **1948, Res. 194:** Right of return for Palestinian refugees: Established the 'Conciliation Commission', free access to Jerusalem and other 'holy places', safe return of refugees, compensation for property damage and/or loss.
3. **1967, Res. 242:** Withdrawal from occupied territories: Became significant during the 'Six-Day War'
4. **1973, Res. 338:** Ceasefire and peace negotiations: With respect to the 'Yom Kippur War'
5. **1979, Res. 446:** Condemnation of Israeli settlements.
6. **1980, Res. 478:** Condemnation of 'Jerusalem Law': Arbitrary law propounded by Israel to directly control the territory of Jerusalem. The UN had already previously termed these claims as invalid.
7. **2016, Res. 2334:** Condemnation of settlement expansion.
8. **2023, ES-10/21 and ES-10/22:** Gaza conflict responses
9. **2024, ES-10/23 and 2735:** Upgrading Palestine's UN status and ceasefire calls.

(Sourced from UN website)

8. Potential Reforms by Treaty Organisations

1. UNRWA urges the government of Israel, refugee asylum states and the rest of the warring parties to-

- a. To uphold and preserve the UNRWA Mandate and recognise the necessity of UNRWA's continued ability to operate, given its irreplaceable role in education, health, and protection of Palestinian refugees.
- b. The need to protect schools and hospitals, and respect educational institutions as well as medical facilities under International Humanitarian Law.
- c. Establish full and uninterrupted humanitarian access achieved by the lifting of all blockades on food, water, medicine, and educational materials.
- d. Ensure immediate ceasefire along with the stoppage of all hostilities in order to halt the ongoing killing, injury,

and traumatising of children, disabled and the rest of the general public.

2. UNRWA urges all constituting parties to take prompt steps to ensure-

- a. The development of a comprehensive education recovery plan, which includes emergency learning programmes and a long-term reconstruction strategy for Gaza's school infrastructure.
- b. The development of an effective large-scale as well as socio-culturally accepted mental health programmes to combat trauma, especially in children, through community based interventions.
- c. Documentation of violations of children's rights and subsequent reference of this in appropriate international justice mechanisms.

- d. Development of a nutrition emergency response system that focuses on restoration of WASH infrastructure and emergency food distribution targeting all children under five.

3. UNRWA urges the international community and all warring parties to develop humanitarian corridors that particularly safeguard individuals with disabilities who otherwise become victims due to their apparent liabilities. These actions must include-

- a. Ensure “disability-responsive humanitarian assistance” in all/most aid operations, by ensuring corridor design that benefits the disabled, shelter provision, food distribution, and medical services.
- b. Lift classification of assistive devices as “dual-use” objects in order to ensure uninterrupted entry in Gaza.

4. Mandatory Corridor

Notification Protocol-

Create a binding UN-designed system where all sides to an active conflict must pre-report to humanitarian agencies of a military action along a given corridor, and have at least 72 hours’ notice before any action that could affect the integrity of a corridor, based on UNDSS GPS alert networks already in operation in South Sudan and Syria.

5. EU Union Resettlement and Humanitarian Admission Framework Regulation 2024/1350-

The Regulation was adopted as the EU Pact on Migration and Asylum Regulation to provide a Union Resettlement and Humanitarian Admission Framework that presents common eligibility and admission guidelines. In the framework of the 2024 to 2025 scheme, 14 EU countries made 61000 resettlement and humanitarian admission pledges. In December 2025, the first biannual Union Humanitarian Admission Plan of 2026-2027 was

adopted, which offers a legal model to be used to set up humanitarian corridors into safe states that can be duplicated.

6. UN Security Council 2730 Resolution-

Resolution 2730, which has 97 co-sponsors, requests all parties to armed conflict to move without delay and conclusively to end the use of explosive devices in contravention of IHL and to deplore the unlawful denial of humanitarian access. It requires the Secretary-General to report promptly when there are general dangers to humanitarian staff and requests that administrative procedures be made simpler, preventing the provision of aid.

7. UN General Assembly Resolution-

ES-10/21; Humanitarian Ceasefire Demand Passed, 153 in favour. This Emergency Special Session resolution declared an immediate humanitarian ceasefire in Gaza, the unconditional release of all hostages,

the unimpeded delivery of humanitarian aid and required all the parties to act in compliance with the International Humanitarian Law, which is the clearest expression of international consensus on the crisis.

8. ICJ Provisional Measures Order (January 2024) -

The International Court of Justice has passed binding provisional measures that require Israel to do everything in its power to stop any acts of genocide, allow humanitarian aid to reach Gaza without hindrance and to preserve evidence of alleged human rights abuses as a legal precedent to judicial intervention in active humanitarian crises.

9. Obligatory Extension of UNRWA-

Funding by a Treaty-based Humanitarian trust Fund. This should be in the form of a multilateral treaty-based humanitarian trust fund, where all member states with a specified minimum level of GDP contribution to UNRWA must contribute on a proportional basis to the continuation of their services to the Palestinian refugees,

insulating them against the political cuts of individual states.

10. Mandatory Rehabilitation Protocol on Conflict-

Damaged Humanitarian Infrastructure
Mandatory Rehabilitation Protocol
organisations such as the ICRC and UN-Habitat should come up with a binding Rehabilitation Protocol where occupied powers and warring parties are required to fund and facilitate the repairs and recovery of destroyed humanitarian infrastructure, such as hospitals, water systems and UNRWA schools, within a specific time period after ceasefire agreements.

11. Independent Vetting and Neutrality Certification Mechanism to Humanitarian Agencies-

The UN Secretary General should introduce an independent annual certification mechanism in order to ensure the neutrality, impartiality and operational integrity of humanitarian agencies in war-torn areas that are providing agencies like UNRWA with internationally recognised certifications that guard against defunding campaigns in their favour.

12. Rehabilitation Framework of Palestinian Refugee Children-

UNICEF, UNRWA and WHO should establish a binding Rehabilitation Framework, particularly addressing the needs of Palestinian refugee children that specifically embodies the following: physical rehabilitation of war victims, psychosocial recovery programmes, education restoration routes and trauma-sensitive care to ensure that no war victim child is deprived of a right to rehabilitation and educational reintegration.

13. The World Health Organization (WHO) requests governments and humanitarian organizations to-

1. Requires governments to restore healthcare systems by rebuilding hospitals, creating medical supply chains and training healthcare workers.
2. Requires organizations to develop mental health programs and trauma recovery programs which specifically address the needs of people who have experienced extended violent conflicts.

3. Requires organizations to establish protected humanitarian corridors, which will enable medical evacuations and treatment access for patients.

treatment, food security and shelter assistance.

14. The United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA) requests all Member States, host nations and conflicting parties to take the following actions-

1. International organizations should develop new programs which will restore damaged educational institutions and medical centers and vital infrastructure in both refugee camps and areas that suffered from armed conflict.
2. The organization must maintain regular access to educational resources, medical treatment and mental health assistance services which serve women, children and displaced individuals.
3. Humanitarian corridors need to provide safe access, which enables the transport of rehabilitation aid that includes medical

15. The United Nations Security Council (UNSC) needs to create a distinct Humanitarian Corridor Protection Mechanism through its UN Security Council General Assembly Resolution-

1. The United Nations, together with its member states, must establish operational procedures that require the deployment of 50 to 100 UN-certified neutral observers for each major corridor, together with their supporting surveillance and reporting units.
2. The organization needs to create a complete real-time violation reporting system which operates 24 hours per day. The organization needs to create a system which enables instant documentation of incidents that will be reported to relevant UN bodies within 12 hours.
3. The organization requires bi-weekly public reports, which will show

corridor safety conditions together with any violations that occurred. The organization needs these reports because they will demonstrate its accountability to International Humanitarian Law (IHL) standards.

16. Creation of a Binding “Humanitarian Access Guarantee Clause” in Ceasefire Agreements-

1. Member States, together with mediators, must make sure that every ceasefire agreement contains a minimum 72-hour humanitarian access window, which needs to be provided each week.
2. The entry of 100 to 150 humanitarian aid trucks must be established as a daily requirement during ceasefire periods through designated corridors.
3. The United Nations must create automatic review systems which operate within 48 hours to investigate cases when humanitarian access rights have been obstructed or violated.

17. The United Nations should establish the Neutral Humanitarian Air Bridge System, which needs to begin operating its humanitarian flights at least five times each day to deliver essential supplies to areas which remain unreachable because of active warfare-

1. The organization needs to dedicate 30 to 40 per cent of its air transportation operations to deliver medical supplies and emergency healthcare products.
2. The organization needs to establish monitoring systems which will enable independent UN agencies to oversee all operational activities for the purpose of maintaining complete operational transparency while preventing any potential security breaches.

18. Formation of an International “Humanitarian Corridor Coordination Task Force (HCCTF)-

1. The proposal recommends that the central coordination body establish an operational system which

requires representatives from 10 to 15 essential member states, United Nations agencies and humanitarian organizations to participate.

2. The organization will conduct daily operational meetings, which will establish corridor access procedures

,handle logistics operations and address newly developed threats.

3. The organization will operate a centralized digital system, which will deliver real-time updates about aid distribution progress, hallway operational status and scheduled delivery times.



unrwa
الاونروا

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

2. Country-specific Action

Different countries respond to the protection of humanitarian corridors and preservation of International Humanitarian Law (IHL) according to their military activities and their ability to provide humanitarian support, which they need during conflicts in Gaza and throughout the Middle Eastern region.

1. The **United States** has established itself as the main force which enables humanitarian organizations to reach their operational areas through its diplomatic efforts and its military assistance programs. The United States provided support for emergency humanitarian pauses from 2023 to 2024, which enabled aid shipments to enter Gaza while working together with local partners to enhance the flow of aid trucks through crossing points. The United States disclosed its intention to establish a temporary maritime humanitarian corridor, which will facilitate the delivery of substantial aid shipments while maintaining its financial support for humanitarian organizations such as the United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA), which undergoes scheduled financial assessments.
2. **China** has concentrated its efforts on diplomatic and multilateral frameworks while establishing its position that an urgent ceasefire should be implemented together with expanded humanitarian access to all United Nations operations. China has backed resolutions which protect civilian lives and permit unrestricted delivery of humanitarian assistance, while it maintains that UN-run humanitarian corridors must follow international standards of neutral operation and territorial sovereignty protection.
3. **The government of Israel** controls all entry points into Gaza because it serves as one of the main conflict parties and has established both emergency evacuation routes and humanitarian pathways, which operate within specific time periods

for people to exit the area. The organization approved entry for aid trucks through the Kerem Shalom border crossing after security teams conducted their mandatory inspections, and they implemented restrictions on items which could be used for multiple purposes. The delivery of humanitarian aid faced major obstacles because of two factors, which restricted fuel availability and operational capabilities.

4. **India** has conducted specific humanitarian programs through Operation Ajay, which began in 2023, to evacuate its citizens while providing assistance to them and to Palestinian civilians through their medical and disaster relief shipments and their financial support program. India has established its public position about safe and ongoing humanitarian routes, which allow continuous movement of aid while maintaining its diplomatic relations with other nations.

5. **Yemen** serves as an important case study which demonstrates all the difficulties nations face when they attempt to maintain humanitarian corridors during extended periods of fighting. Humanitarian access to conflict areas has relied on United Nations-negotiated corridors, which face ongoing issues because of blockades and active combat. The Yemeni situation demonstrates that humanitarian activities become impossible when insecure conditions exist, together with complete infrastructure failure and political parties losing their ability to govern.

6. **Iraq** has provided support to regional humanitarian coordination activities through its delivery of aid, while it has worked to protect civilians and humanitarian staff at international platforms. The Iraqi experience of rebuilding their country after war demonstrates that countries need to establish reconstruction frameworks which include medical facilities and international assistance networks to maintain their humanitarian corridors.

7. **Syria** represents one of the most complicated situations regarding humanitarian access. The United Nations has authorized cross-border aid delivery through its corridors, which include the Bab al-Hawa crossing that needs Security Council

approval. The need for ongoing humanitarian operations in conflict areas faces obstacles because of political conflicts, territorial disputes and security dangers, which make it difficult to keep humanitarian corridors operational.



unrwa
الأونروا

the un agency for
palestine refugees

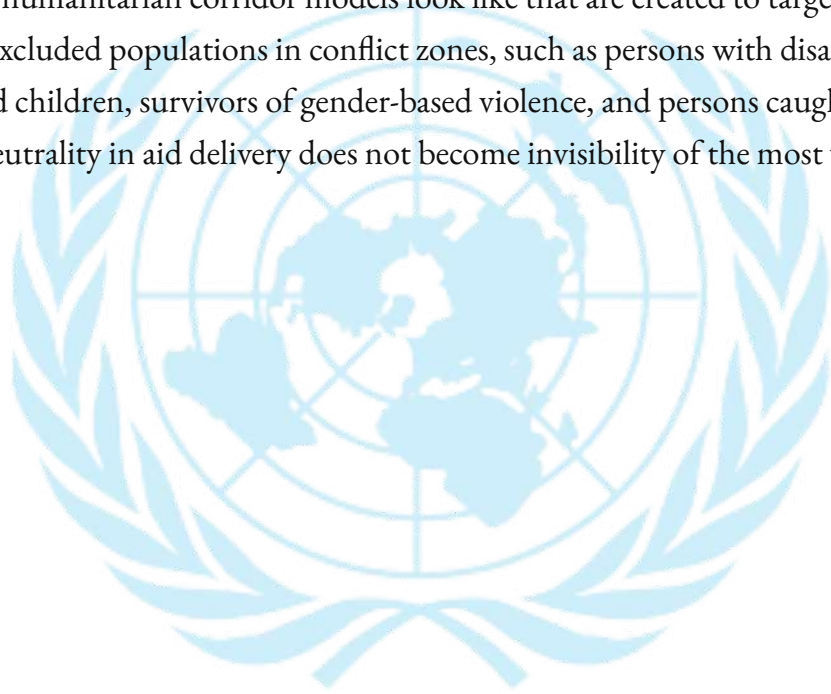
وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

10. Questions a Resolution must answer

1. What are the specific and binding steps to be taken by the member states and the United Nations to make sure that humanitarian corridors into conflict zones, and specifically the ones serving Palestinian refugees in Gaza and the West Bank have been opened and will forever remain open, adequately resourced, and free of any military interference, closure, or seizure by any side to the conflict?
2. What could the international community do to put in place binding verification measures to make humanitarian ceasefires a real, sustainable protection of civilians, and not a tactical reprieve to re-equip, re-establish military dominance and control of corridors and aid routes?
3. Since UNRWA is already the only institution with the necessary scale to provide uninterrupted humanitarian services to over 5.9 million Palestinian refugees, what other institutional mechanisms would be required or what supplemental institutional mechanisms would be necessary to ensure continuous humanitarian services and how can a non-weaponized, treaty-based funding structure be developed which cannot be ruined by the withdrawal of any single donor state or used as diplomatic leverage?
4. What does the international community do with the direct targeting of humanitarian workers, UN personnel and the protection of the facilities like schools and hospitals that are turned into emergency shelters in active conflict regions, and what do the international community call an immediate, binding accountability response when such attacks occur?
5. What can the international community do to prevent the forced and irreversible displacement of Palestinian refugees out of their land so that the temporary evacuation due to safety concerns is not confused with demographic engineering on a permanent basis, and how should any solution uphold the right of return as well as provide the immediate humanitarian aid?

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
لللاجئين الفلسطينيين

6. What would humanitarian corridor models look like that are created to target the most systematically excluded populations in conflict zones, such as persons with disabilities, unaccompanied children, survivors of gender-based violence, and persons caught in militarized areas, so that neutrality in aid delivery does not become invisibility of the most vulnerable populations?



unrwa
الاونروا

the un agency for
palestine refugees

وكالة الأمم المتحدة
للاجئين الفلسطينيين

11. Bibliography

1. <https://www.iemed.org/publication/iran-continuity-in-foreign-policy-towards-israel-after-the-war-in-gaza/>
2. <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1111/mepo.12777>
3. <https://www.unrwa.org/where-we-work/gaza-strip>
4. <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2024/8/13/whats-behind-russias-soft-power-moves-on-israel-palestine>
5. <http://en.kremlin.ru/events/president/news/76894>
6. <https://www.ochaopt.org>
7. <https://www.chinadailyhk.com/hk/article/589921>
8. <https://global.chinadaily.com.cn/a/202512/06/WS6933a897a310d6866eb2d357.html>
9. <https://www.who.int/emergencies/situations/oPt>
10. https://www.fmprc.gov.cn/eng/xw/zwbd/202503/t20250325_11581779.html
11. <https://www.diplomatie.gouv.fr/en/country-files/israel-palestine/news/2025/article/united-nations-high-level-international-conference-new-york-declaration-on-the>
12. <https://foreignpolicy.com/2025/10/30/israel-palestine-pa-two-state-solution-reforms/>
13. <https://www.securitycouncilreport.org/monthly-forecast/2025-10/the-middle-east-including-the-palestinian-question-22.php>
14. <https://www.un.org/unispal/high-level-conference-two-state-solution-july2025/>
15. <https://www.reuters.com/world/middle-east/>
16. <https://news.un.org/en/tags/gaza>
17. <https://www.icrc.org/en/where-we-work/middle-east/israel-and-occupied-territories>
18. <https://www.unrwa.org/resources/emergency-appeals/syria-lebanon-and-jordan-emergency-appeal-2025>
19. <https://www.unrwa.org/resources/reports/syria-lebanon-and-jordan-emergency-appeal-2025-progress-report>
20. <https://www.unrwa.org/resources/emergency-appeals/syria-lebanon-and-jordan-humanitarian-appeal-2026>
21. <https://www.unrwa.org/where-we-work/lebanon>
22. <https://www.unrwa.org/syria-crisis>
23. <https://www.unrwa.org/newsroom/news-releases/over-600000-palestine-refugees-syria-lebanon-and-jordan-need-humanitarian-assistance>